

**Standard Chartered: USD543 billion in retail investor capital could be mobilised to combat climate change in India by 2030**

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Contify Banking News

ATINBK

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Standard Chartered's Sustainable Banking Report 2023 reveals that USD543 billion of retail investor capital could be mobilised towards climate investments in India by 2030. Energy efficiency, resilient infrastructure, and renewables are expected to attract the highest investment. The report also highlights that 96% of investors in India are interested in climate investing, with making a positive impact and personal values being the top motivations. However, there are multiple barriers holding investors back from translating their interest into investment. To overcome these barriers, financial institutions, regulators, companies, and individuals must establish a wider range of climate assets and innovate new climate assets to match emerging investor interests. Digital and fintech solutions will play a crucial role in simplifying processes for investors. Additionally, aligning reporting standards and mandating minimum disclosure requirements will boost investor confidence.

Original Press Release:

Nov. 29 -- Standard Chartered issued the following news release:

- Energy efficiency, resilient infrastructure and renewables are set to attract the highest investment
- 96% of investors in India are interested in climate investing, the highest among all markets surveyed
- Making a positive impact and personal values are the top investor motivations

Standard Chartered's latest Sustainable Banking Report 2023 reveals USD543 billion of retail investor capital could be mobilised towards climate investments in India by 2030. The research – based on investor interest from a survey of 1,800 respondents in 10 growth markets across Asia, Africa and the Middle East – identifies a global potential of USD3.4 trillion for climate investing, highlighting the power of individuals to combat climate change.

Within climate investing in India, USD324 billion could flow into mitigation themes – energy efficiency, renewables and energy storage are set to attract the most capital. USD219 billion could be mobilised towards adaptation including resilient infrastructure, biodiversity and food systems.

The survey shows 96% of investors in India are interested in climate investing, which is the highest among all markets surveyed, and 84% of them want to increase capital flows towards climate. They are mainly motivated by making a positive impact and personal values when making such investments.

However, multiple barriers, which vary by investor segments, are holding them back from translating their interest into investment.

Disclaimer: Table can be viewed at: <https://www.sc.com/in/retail-investor-capital-could-be-mobilised/>

The industry needs to help investors overcome these barriers to unlock the potential of retail capital. Financial institutions, regulators, companies and individuals must make a concerted effort to establish a wider range of climate assets to drive greater retail participation.

Asset managers and banks must also work to innovate new climate assets to match emerging investor interests, such as biodiversity and the blue economy. Financial institutions have a critical role to play in mobilising retail capital via three pillars – empowering investors with information, product customisation and outcome-based information. Digital and fintech solutions will play an enabling role and simplify processes for investors.

The industry across the world also needs to align reporting standards and mandate minimum disclosure requirements to boost investor confidence.

Marc Van de Walle, Global Head, **Wealth Management**, Deposits & Mortgages, Standard Chartered, said: “Financing our collective response to climate change is a critical challenge. Overall climate mitigation and adaptation face an annual funding gap of trillions of dollars. Institutional capital is often the focus when mobilising funds to bridge this gap – the scale and power of retail investor capital is a lesser-known opportunity. To overcome the current disconnect between investor interest and the scale of climate investments, the industry needs to improve access to solutions, harmonise reporting standards and measurement of impact. We continue to work closely with our clients to match their investments to their areas of interest, so they can help finance solutions for a more sustainable future.”

Saurabh Jain, India Head, **Wealth Management**, Standard Chartered Bank, said: “Climate change is a key challenge for India, with frequent extreme weather events, a growing population and increasing urbanisation highlighting the need to bring rapid focus into building climate-resilient infrastructure and staying on course to achieve the country’s net zero targets. Our report shows that over half a trillion dollars could be available from retail investors to finance climate investments. **Wealth managers** can play a big role in channelling these investments into impactful financial solutions. At Standard Chartered Bank, India, we continue to work with our clients and asset managers to mobilise capital for climate action through innovative products.”

About the Sustainable Banking Report 2023

The Sustainable Banking Report 2023, commissioned by Standard Chartered and prepared by PwC Singapore, surveyed 1,800 individuals from three investor segments (Affluent, High-Net-Worth (HNW) and Next Generation High-Net-Worth (NextGen HNW)) across 10 key markets in Asia, Africa and the Middle East – Mainland China, Hong Kong, Taiwan, South Korea, Singapore, Malaysia, India, the UAE, Nigeria and Kenya.

Standard Chartered

Standard Chartered Bank has been operating in India with a continuous presence of over 160 years making it one of the oldest foreign banks in the country. The Bank has a network of 100 branches across 42 cities. Key business segments include Corporate, Commercial and Institutional Banking and Consumer, Private and Business Banking. For more information, visit <https://www.sc.com/in/>

Globally, we are a leading international banking group, with a presence in 53 of the world’s most dynamic markets and serving clients in a further 64. Our purpose is to drive commerce and prosperity through our unique diversity, and our heritage and values are expressed in our brand promise, here for good.

Standard Chartered PLC is listed on the London and Hong Kong Stock Exchanges.

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Source: Standard Chartered

[Category: Banks, Utilities, Electric Utilities, ESG]

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Markets

Over \$0.5 trillion in retail investor capital could be mobilised to combat climate change in India by 2030: Standard Chartered

BL Mumbai Bureau

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Retail investor capital aggregating \$543 billion could be mobilised towards climate investments in India by 2030, per Standard Chartered's (SC) latest Sustainable Banking Report 2023.

Within climate investing in India, \$324 billion could flow into mitigation themes – energy efficiency, renewables and energy storage are set to attract the most capital, the report said.

Further, \$219 billion could be mobilised towards adaptation including resilient infrastructure, biodiversity and food systems.

The research – based on investor interest from a survey of 1,800 respondents in 10 growth markets across Asia, Africa and the Middle East – identified a global potential of \$3.4 trillion for climate investing, highlighting the power of individuals to combat climate change.

The survey shows 96 per cent of investors in India are interested in climate investing, which is the highest among all markets surveyed, and 84 per cent of them want to increase capital flows towards climate, per a SC statement.

They are mainly motivated by making a positive impact and personal values when making such investments, it added.

Multiple barriers

However, multiple barriers (such as accessibility, comparability, comprehensibility, ambivalence/fatigue, perceived higher risks, etc), which vary by investor segments, are holding them back from translating their interest into investment.

"The industry needs to help investors overcome these barriers to unlock the potential of retail capital. Financial institutions, regulators, companies and individuals must make a concerted effort to establish a wider range of climate assets to drive greater retail participation. Asset managers and banks must also work to innovate new climate assets to match emerging investor interests, such as biodiversity and the blue economy," suggested the SC report.

SC emphasised that financial institutions have a critical role to play in mobilising retail capital via three pillars – empowering investors with information, product customisation and outcome-based information.

Marc Van de Walle, Global Head, **Wealth Management**, Deposits and Mortgages, Standard Chartered, observed that when it comes to climate investments, institutional capital is often the focus for mobilising funds to bridge the annual funding gap of trillions of dollars. The scale and power of retail investor capital is a lesser-known opportunity.

"To overcome the current disconnect between investor interest and the scale of climate investments, the industry needs to improve access to solutions, harmonise reporting standards and measurement of impact," he said.

Saurabh Jain, India Head, **Wealth Management**, Standard Chartered Bank, said **wealth managers** can play a big role in channelling climate investments into impactful financial solutions.

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Business

Retail investor capital of \$543 billion could be mobilised to combat climate change in India by 2030, says Standard Chartered survey

FE Business

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Retail investor capital of \$543 billion could be mobilised towards climate investments in India by 2030, said Standard Chartered's latest Sustainable Banking Report 2023. The research – based on investor interest from a survey of 1,800 respondents in 10 growth markets across Asia, Africa and the Middle East – identifies a global potential of \$3.4 trillion for climate investing, highlighting the power of individuals to combat climate change.

Per the findings of the report, within climate investing in India, \$324 billion could flow into mitigation themes – energy efficiency, renewables and energy storage are set to attract the most capital. Further, \$219 billion could be mobilised towards adaptation including resilient infrastructure, biodiversity and food systems.

Also ReadMall space in India to rise by 30-35 million sqft in 3-4 years on strong recovery in retail sales, says CRISIL Ratings

The survey shows that 96 per cent of investors in India are interested in climate investing, which is the highest among all markets surveyed, and 84 per cent of them want to increase capital flows towards climate. They are mainly motivated by making a positive impact and personal values when making such investments, it added. However, multiple barriers, which vary by investor segments, are holding them back from translating their interest into investment.

"The industry needs to help investors overcome these barriers to unlock the potential of retail capital. Financial institutions, regulators, companies and individuals must make a concerted effort to establish a wider range of climate assets to drive greater retail participation," the survey report said. Asset managers and banks must also work to innovate new climate assets to match emerging investor interests, such as biodiversity and the blue economy, it added. Also, financial institutions have a role to play in mobilising retail capital via three pillars – empowering investors with information, product customisation and outcome-based information. For further boosting investor confidence, the industry across the world also needs to align reporting standards and mandate minimum disclosure requirements.

Marc Van de Walle, Global Head, **Wealth Management**, Deposits & Mortgages, Standard Chartered, said, "Financing our collective response to climate change is a critical challenge. Overall climate mitigation and adaptation face an annual funding gap of trillions of dollars. Institutional capital is often the focus when mobilising funds to bridge this gap – the scale and power of retail investor capital is a lesser-known opportunity. To overcome the current disconnect between investor interest and the scale of climate investments, the industry needs to improve access to solutions, harmonise reporting standards and measurement of impact."

Saurabh Jain, India Head, **Wealth Management**, Standard Chartered Bank, said, "Climate change is a key challenge for India, with frequent extreme weather events, a growing population and increasing urbanisation highlighting the need to bring rapid focus into building climate-resilient infrastructure and staying on course to achieve the country's net zero targets. Our report shows that over half a trillion dollars could be available from retail investors to finance climate investments. **Wealth managers** can play a big role in channeling these investments into impactful financial solutions."

[Retail investor capital of \\$543 billion could be mobilised towards climate investments in India by 2030.](#)

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Business

HSBC hires UBS's Gautam Anand for role serving India's rich diaspora

Bloomberg

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HSBC Holdings Plc hired a senior **private banking** executive from UBS Group AG where he ran a team serving wealthy Indians who live overseas. Gautam Anand was appointed Global Coordinator for Global India, the Middle East, North Africa and Europe from Dec. 1, according to an internal memo seen by Bloomberg News.

"Our strategy is grow Singapore as an international wealth hub as part of our ambition to be Asia's leading wealth manager," Tommy Leung, the bank's head of **private banking** for South Asia, said in the memo. Anand's appointment will support the bank's ability to serve clients across markets, said Leung, who joined the bank earlier this year also from UBS.

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A HSBC spokesman in Hong Kong confirmed the memo's contents.

Anand joined UBS in January and left shortly after at the end of August, according to the Monetary Authority of Singapore's records, amid disruptions thrown up by the Swiss lender's takeover of Credit Suisse. Before UBS, he was a team head for non-resident Indians at Credit Suisse and was there for almost a decade.

India has attracted interest from global and regional firms including HSBC and UBS that are seeking to boost financial services for the rich given its rapid economic growth. The country's growing wealth management industry could be worth \$5.5 trillion by 2025, according to Bloomberg Intelligence analyst Sarah Jane Mahmud.

[HSBC Holdings Plc hired a senior **private banking** executive from UBS Group AG where he ran a team serving wealthy Indians who live overseas. Image: Reuters](#)

Document FIEXON0020231129ejbs00023

Exclusive: Former UBS senior NRI banker to join HSBC GPB

Priyanka Boghani

224 words

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Citywire Asia

CWIRAS

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A former senior banker at UBS Global Wealth Management who covered the global Indian diaspora is set to join HSBC Global **Private Banking**, Citywire Asia has learnt.

Gautam Anand is slated to join HSBC's **private banking** operations, where he will cover the non-resident Indian (NRI) segment.

A spokesperson from HSBC declined to comment on the hire.

Anand was at UBS GWM for eight months before he exited, as [reported](#) earlier by Citywire Asia. Prior to UBS, he was at Credit Suisse where he helped boost the bank's coverage of wealthy Indians.

Before that, Anand worked at ANZ as head of affluent banking and head of NRI, Asia Pacific. He also previously worked at ABN Amro as its southeast Asia international wealth management head.

HSBC GPB has a new Asia chief, with Lok Yim stepping in from Deutsche Bank, following the retirement of Siew Meng Tan.

Earlier this year, the **private bank** [snapped](#) up Manish Vyas, an NRI, Middle East and North Africa banker, based in Hong Kong.

Prior to that, the bank hired senior **private banker**, Hemant Geriani from Standard Chartered **Private Bank** to look after the global India business. Geriani is based in Singapore and reports to Manoj Ramarao, head of global India business, who joined in February from EFG.

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Money & Banking

Perking up deposit rates can only help in the short term: Prashant Joshi, DBS Bank India

Hamsini Karthik

958 words

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BusinessLine Online

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English

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We probably overestimated the speed at which the change from physical to digital would happen, says Prashant Joshi, Managing Director and Head, Consumer Banking Group, DBS Bank India. In this candid interview, he talks about the need for branch presence and why plays deposit rates could only be a short-term game. Excerpts:

DBS as a model has prided itself on being digital only, and then you went shopping for Lakshmi Vilas Bank, which had a strong branch presence. How has this transition internally been accepted?

Particularly in India, we started with the hypothesis that people will move digital and will be mobile-only. But as we progressed, what we realised was that while it was gaining ground, what people still needed was the assurance of the branch and the brand, which they needed to see somewhere. You can't have very few branches; be a virtual brand and expect to get customers to shift their loyalties and relationships to you. If you want to become the main relationship bank for the customer, plus if the customer has to leave reasonable balances with you and do more than just payments, then it is pertinent to have a physical network. That said, we are seeing that the proportion of digital transactions continues to increase. The direction that we took was right; probably we overestimated the speed at which the change would happen. The change was more gradual than we thought and that is where the need for physical network comes in.

The image of DBS in people's minds is that it caters to NRI and HNI customers, whereas some of the products you offer, like gold loans, aren't so. What is your target market?

It is a very valid question. When we started, we were largely a corporate bank and then followed it up with a **wealth management** offering. This is the HNI piece and the Treasures proposition that we have for **wealth management**. Contrary to what a lot of people think, the DBS Treasures proposition has been strengthened since the amalgamation of Lakshmi Vilas Bank with DBS Bank India. Earlier, we talked about the top 8–10 cities in the country. Now we are saying that we want to position ourselves as a preferred **wealth management** service provider in the top 30 cities in the country where 65 per cent of India's deposits and 75 per cent of India's **wealth management** AUM reside. Our touch points have increased by many folds. Rather than diluting our brand, it has become stronger. Now we are going to the tier-2 and tier-3 cities where other banks have 5–7 branches. We have a right to win in these markets through our distribution, brand, and tech platform. To your second point, the gold loan, unsecured personal loans, credit cards, and MSME financing businesses are emerging affluent or mass-market products. The strategy is that in the top 30 markets, we must become the preferred deposit and **wealth management** service provider. In the inherited franchise, we look at the emerging affluent and focus on these products. In the southern geographies, our gold loan business, MSME financing, and affordable housing finance are the key products where we have the advantage of distribution. When we don't have the advantage of distribution, we won't try to compete with everyone else there. That is how we are positioning ourselves.

You've sort of filled product stacks in the retail segment.

Yes. I think we are pretty much done in terms of the product. Now, within products, variants will keep coming. For example, we started with credit cards on a co-branded platform. Then we came out with a card specifically for our **wealth management** customers. For our emerging affluent customers, we have launched a card called DBS Spark. We may have one more variant coming in.

You've just entered the affordable housing segment, which is currently populated by NBFCs.

Banks have a natural advantage in these products because once you have the distribution, the capital requirements for these products are relatively low. There is a PSL advantage, and the credit loss rates for these

products have been very manageable. Also, refinancing is available for these assets. For NBFCs and HFCs, who may have built the business up to a particular scale, going beyond the point becomes difficult because liquidity starts becoming a challenge.

One of the biggest changes since the LVB acquisition is the repo rate. Has that altered your approach to mopping up liabilities?

Whether big or small, every bank is trying to do something or the other to get more deposits; however, just paying a higher rate or just being competitive in terms of interest rates doesn't help. What is even more important is the customer journey, experience, service standards, and the brand promise. The rate can help in the short term to perk up your deposits, but unless it's sustainable, it won't help because the product is fungible. For example, today we have a flexi fixed deposit, which was referred to as sweep-out deposits many years ago, and active money now. Brand names have changed, but effectively, the theme is the same.

How do you read the signs in the personal loans segment?

Unsecured personal loans represent 4 per cent of our total balance sheet, typically consisting of monthly amortising 36-month loans. Evaluating the product's lifetime profitability is crucial. Delinquencies become apparent after 18 to 20 months, peaking in the last year when the loan balance is lowest. Effective underwriting, monitoring, and collection practices can contribute to profitability throughout the cycle.

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Exclusive: StanChart PB's market head for SG, South Asia, MENA exits

Priyanka Boghani
235 words
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Ravi Ramakrishnan has stepped down from his Singapore-based role, where he was responsible for overseeing clients from Singapore, South Asia, the Middle East and the UK. His departure comes as the bank is still rejigging its Southeast Asia team, following the resignations of Andrew Ho and Lawrence Goh.

Ramakrishnan was [slated](#) to move to Dubai to cover the non-resident Indian and broader South Asian community, Citywire Asia understood. His role in Singapore has been absorbed by Vijai Krovvidi, whose remit has expanded to cover Goh and Ho's roles.

The British lender has [reshuffled](#) its Southeast Asia team coverage. It recently hired UBS Global Wealth Management's star banker, Tian Ong Foo, as regional head of Southeast Asia and Singapore location head. Vinay Gandhi was appointed as global head of the South Asian community and regional head of Africa, Middle East and Europe in a **private banking** role from 1 January next year.

Ramakrishnan joined Standard Chartered in 2018, where he was made the market head of the global South Asia community for the **private bank**. Before this role, he was a market head in the Middle East and Africa at DBS **Private Bank**. He also worked at HSBC, RBC and Clariden Leu across Asia, North America and the Middle East.

A spokesperson from Standard Chartered declined to comment.

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Former BoS EAM head joins Standard Chartered

Priyanka Boghani

213 words

14 November 2023

Citywire Asia

CWIRAS

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A former Hong Kong external asset manager head at Bank of Singapore has joined Standard Chartered **Private Bank**.

Steven Lee joined the British lender as its Greater China and North Asia head of financial intermediaries on 24 October, where his remit is to cover multi-family offices and external asset managers. He reports directly to Peter Tung, regional head of **private banking**, in Greater China and North Asia.

Lee was at the Bank of Singapore for almost two years and at Credit Suisse as a senior relationship manager focusing on the EAM industry for six years. He has also held various roles at ABN AMRO Bank, CICC, Goldman Sachs and Citi.

A spokesperson from the bank confirmed his hire.

'With his strong background in **private banking** and EAM, Steven will undoubtedly make a significant impact in driving our EAM strategy,' Tung said.

There has been a bit of movement at **private banks** with dedicated EAM desks.

Last month, Credit Suisse's EAM investment advisory head for Apac, Roy Lee, [left](#) the bank to join Swiss structured products specialist Leonteq.

Earlier this year, Lombard Odier [recruited](#) Singapore-based Emmanuel Guillaume from Vontobel, replacing Maurice Troesch who left to cover EAMs and multi-family offices at DBS Bank.

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Singapore - Life Insurance - Competitive Landscape

3,776 words

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MarketLine Industry Profiles

DMRP

English

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The Singaporean market is highly consolidated, with the top four leading players generating a combined market share of 77.1%. The largest of these players is the Great Eastern Life Assurance Company, which alone has a 38.2% market share. This is followed by Manulife, Prudential, and AIA Group Limited. The market leaders are based in Singapore, Hong Kong, and the UK, indicating the well-diversified geographical presence of insurance providers in the market. Most of the leading players in the market gained their strong market presence through diversified product portfolios and numerous awards the companies were able to win. In addition, the life insurance market in general consists of debt offerings, acquisitions, and finance ventures, as it is the primary characteristic of companies operating in this market and one of the most important techniques for raising capital.

Who are the leading players?

The Great Eastern Life Assurance Company Ltd

Great Eastern Life, a subsidiary of Singapore-based Great Eastern Holdings Limited, is the largest provider of insurance services in Singapore with a 37.8% market share in 2022. The company is based in Singapore and offers life protection insurance, health, savings, investment, retirement, dependent liability, critical illness, child education, disability, travel, car, home, maid, education, pregnancy, and wealth accumulation protection insurance. The company generated \$12.5 billion in revenue in 2021. Its commercial insurance products comprise general insurance, corporate, employee benefits, workplace benefits, group, portable medical benefits, life accident protection, hospitalization, death, air travel, medical expense, terrorism, and permanent disability insurance, among others. The company offers services such as claims services, financial calculators, and customer support services.

Manulife (Singapore) Pte Ltd

Manulife Singapore is the second largest provider of insurance services in Singapore with a 15.4% market share in 2022. The company is based in Singapore and offers life insurance, personal, family, health, children, savings, investment, retirement, legacy, family protection, business, and direct insurance products. The company generated revenue of \$61.8 billion in 2021. Its financial solutions comprise **wealth management** solutions, investment-linked policy funds summaries and reports, unit trust funds solutions, fund management, and retirement solutions. Manulife Singapore provides economic solutions for the regulatory environment. The company caters to banks, financial advisory firms, individuals, groups, families, and corporations.

Prudential Plc

Prudential is the third largest provider of insurance services in Singapore with a 15.3% market share in 2022. The company is based in London, UK, and is a financial services group that offers long-term savings and protection products. The group, through its subsidiaries, provides retirement benefits and insurance coverage for various risks such as illness, death, and critical life events. The company generated \$26.5 billion in revenue in 2021. It also provides investment solutions across various asset classes, including equities, multi-asset, fixed income, infrastructure, and alternatives. The group offers its products and services to the middle class and aging population through independent agents, regional broker-dealers, independent broker-dealer firms, warehouses, and banks. Its operations are spanned across Asia, Africa, the US, the UK, and Europe.

AIA Group Limited

AIA is the fourth largest provider of insurance services in Singapore with an 8.6% market share in 2022 and operates in the country through its subsidiary AIA Singapore. The company is based in Hong Kong and offers life insurance, medical insurance, accident protection insurance, critical illness insurance, disability protection

insurance, and savings and investment plans to individuals. It generated \$47.5 billion in revenue in 2021 and offers credit insurance, retirement savings, and employee benefits plans to corporate clients. It markets and sells its products and services through a network of partners, agents, and employees. AIA, through its branches and subsidiaries, has a presence across the Asia-Pacific region, including Hong Kong, Thailand, Singapore, Malaysia, China, Korea, the Philippines, Australia, Indonesia, Taiwan, Vietnam, New Zealand, Brunei, India, and Cambodia.

What are the strengths of the leading players?

Great Eastern Life strength lies in its increasing cash position that enables it to meet its short-term obligations with ease. In FY2022, the company reported cash and cash equivalents of SGD9,607.9 million (\$6,968.5 million) vs. SGD9,117.7 million (\$6,612.9 million) in 2021. An increase in cash and cash equivalents can be attributed to the increased value of its short-term holdings such as short-term government bonds and marketable securities and strong cashflows. The group reported improvement in cost efficiency in FY2022. Its operating expenses as a percentage of revenue increased to 92.44% in FY2022 from 93.19% in FY2021. This was due to 37% decrease in operating expenses from SGD18,545.2 million (\$13,450.6 million) in FY2021 to SGD11,688.8 million (\$8,477.7 million) in FY2022. The decrease in operating expense was a result of a decrease in gross claims, maturities, surrenders and annuities, commissions and distribution expenses, management and other expenses, gross change in insurance contract liabilities, and change in insurance contract liabilities ceded to reinsurers. The improvement in cost efficiency resulted in an increase in operating margin. The operating margin increased to 7.6% in FY2022 from 6.8% in FY2021. The company's net investment income improved in FY2022, which enhanced its ability to pay policy claims. It reported a net investment income of SGD2,858 million (\$2,072.9 million) in FY2022 as compared to SGD2,699 million (\$1,957.6 million) in the previous year. Improve in net investment income was due to an increase in dividend income, and investment income of financial assets measured at FVOCI, financial assets mandatorily measured at FVTPL, and financial assets at amortized cost.

Manulife Singapore in 2022 achieved record net income of \$7.3 billion vs. \$2.1 billion in 2017. In Asia, the company is the fastest growing of the top three pan-Asian insurers between 2017 and 2021, from being within the top six pan-Asian insurers. The company's global wealth and asset management business achieved net inflows in 10 of the last 12 quarters. The company bolstered its capital position, achieving a Life Insurance Capital Adequacy Test (LICAT) ratio of 131% for 2022, more than \$20 billion above its supervisory target. The company's Net Promoter Score (NPS) improved at 19 points against the 2017 baseline. The company's customer base expanded from 26 million to 34 million customers worldwide. According to the Global Wealth and Asset Management (Global WAM), the company is one of the largest natural resource asset managers for institutional investors globally. The company is also a leading life insurer in Canada and is a global leader in behavioral insurance. The company has over 116,000 contracted agents and over 100 bank partnerships. Among its bancassurance partnerships, the company has 10 exclusive partnerships. This includes a long-term partnership with DBS Bank across Hong Kong, Singapore, Indonesia, mainland China, and VietinBank in Vietnam, giving access to over 35 million bank customers.

Prudential group has a strong market presence, which facilitates enhancing its financial and operational performance. Prudential operates in 23 markets with 34 life businesses. It serves 19 million customers in Asia and Africa through 170 bank partners, 530,000 agents, and 27,000 bank branches. In FY2022, the group was ranked in top three positions in 12 out of 13 Asian life insurance markets and in top 10 positions in six out of 11 Asian asset management markets. It was ranked number one in the Syariah market in Malaysia and Indonesia. The group operates in eight African countries.

AIA Group 's strong distribution network helps the group to retain its existing clients and attract new clients. The group offers its products and services through multiple channels in 18 markets across Asia-Pacific region. The group distributes its products through agencies, strategic partnerships, independent financial advisers, private banks, brokers, and specialist advisers. The group has bancassurance partnership with Citibank, which covers 18 markets, including the Philippines, Hong Kong, Macau, Australia, China, Korea, Malaysia, Singapore, India, Indonesia, Thailand, and Vietnam. As on December 31, 2022, AIA served more than 41 million individual policy holders and 17 million participating members of group insurance schemes through its distribution network. The group provides a wide range of products and services to its customers to meet their requirements. It offers life insurance, medical insurance, accident protection insurance, critical illness insurance, disability protection insurance, and savings and investment plans to individuals. It also offers credit insurance, retirement savings, and employee benefits plans to corporate clients. It markets and sells its products and services through a network of partners, agents, and employees.

What strategies do the leading players follow?

Manulife Singapore in 2022 set out five strategic priorities— accelerate growth; digital, customer leader; expense efficiency; portfolio optimization; and high performing team. The company's growth is underpinned by powerful economic secular trends. These trends include low insurance penetration, middle-class emergence, and an estimated mortality protection gap of more than \$100 trillion by 2030, driving continued demand for financial solutions.

Prudential Group's strategy focuses on three key strategies: Delivering, Digitalizing, and Humanizing. The group's Delivering strategy intends to safeguard the health and wellbeing of the customers, by expanding the savings and protection business. It aims to focus on tapping growth opportunities in Southeast Asia, the Chinese Mainland and India; and establish Eastspring as a major ethical investor in Asia. The group's Digitalizing strategy aims to accelerate the distribution of the digitally enhanced model and ensure better customer service. It intends to broaden the offering of direct digital insurance products and craft strategic digital alliances. The group's Humanizing strategy aims to upgrade the expertise of the agents, employees, and partner advisers and offer alternatives that are beneficial to all market segments. It intends to ensure that the atmosphere at work is welcoming and fosters a sense of community. Prudential group is taking various strategic initiatives to drive its business. In November 2022, it launched a Diabetes insurance plan, PRUNo Worries, in Thailand. The plan offers coverage mainly for prediabetics and people diagnosed with Type 2 diabetes, up to 70 years of age. In October 2022, Prudential and Google Cloud entered into a partnership agreement to make healthcare and financial security more accessible in Asia and Africa. This partnership supports its digital strategy to leverage AI and advanced analytics to transform the agent and customer experience and to make insurance access easy. In June 2022, the group announced its plans to expand its partnership with Vodafone and Airtel in Ghana. This partnership helps the group to expand its presence in Ghana. In April 2022, the group partnered with Nervotec to help people better manage and monitor their health and stress levels daily. The partnership will help the group to expand its digital health ecosystem.

AIA is taking various strategic initiatives to acquire new customers, which will drive its business growth. In March 2022, AIA agreed to acquire 100% shares in Blue Cross (Asia-Pacific) Insurance Limited (Blue Cross) and 80% shares in Blue Care JV (BVI) Holdings Limited from The Bank of East Asia, Limited (BEA). This acquisition helps the group to expand its distribution partnership with BEA, enhance its health and wellness strategy in Hong Kong, and offer new product offerings to strengthen its distribution channels. In February 2022, AIA introduced AIA One Billion, to engage one billion people in living healthier, longer, better Lives by 2030. In February 2022, the group entered a partnership with GAMA Global, an international leader dedicated to serving the professional development needs and skills of front-line leaders in the investment, insurance, and financial services sectors. This initiative offers AIA agents with access to best-in-class on-demand courses, training, and global leadership events.

This section contains brief overviews of the leading companies in the Singaporean life insurance market.

Company

Company Name: AIA Group Ltd

AIA Group Ltd (AIA) is a life insurance group. It offers life insurance, medical insurance, accident protection insurance, critical illness insurance, disability protection insurance, and savings and investment plans to individuals. It also offers credit insurance, retirement savings, and employee benefits plans to corporate clients. It markets and sells its products and services through a network of partners, agents, and employees. AIA, through its branches and subsidiaries, has presence across Asia-Pacific region, including Hong Kong, Thailand, Macau, Singapore, Malaysia, China, South Korea, the Philippines, Australia, Indonesia, Taiwan, Vietnam, New Zealand, Sri Lanka, Brunei, Myanmar, India, and Cambodia. AIA is headquartered in Hong Kong.

The group reported total weighted premium income of US\$36,176 million for the fiscal year ended December 2022 (FY2022), a decrease of 2% over that in FY2021.

The company reported revenues of (US Dollars) US\$19,606 million for the fiscal year ended December 2022 (FY2022), a decrease of 58.1% over FY2021. In FY2022, the company's operating margin was 2.7%, compared to an operating margin of 18.1% in FY2021. In FY2022, the company recorded a net margin of 1.4%, compared to a net margin of 15.9% in FY2021.

Head office: 35/F Aia Central, No.1 Connaught Road Central, Hong Kong, Hong Kong (China SAR)

Telephone: 85222328888

Number of Employees: 25405

Website: www.aia.com

Financial Year End: December

Ticker: 1299

Stock Exchange: Hong Kong Stock Exchange

Company Overview

AIA Group Ltd (AIA) is a life insurance group. It offers life insurance, medical insurance, accident protection insurance, critical illness insurance, disability protection insurance, and savings and investment plans to individuals. It also offers credit insurance, retirement savings, and employee benefits plans to corporate clients. It markets and sells its products and services through a network of partners, agents, and employees. AIA, through its branches and subsidiaries, has presence across Asia-Pacific region, including Hong Kong, Thailand, Macau, Singapore, Malaysia, China, South Korea, the Philippines, Australia, Indonesia, Taiwan, Vietnam, New Zealand, Sri Lanka, Brunei, Myanmar, India, and Cambodia. AIA is headquartered in Hong Kong.

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Business Description

AIA Group Ltd (AIA) is a provider of life insurance provider in the Asia-Pacific region. It offers a range of products including retirement savings plans, life insurance, and accident and health insurance to individual customers. The group provides employee benefits, credit life, and pension services to corporate clients. Through its subsidiaries and branches, the group provides its products and services in 18 countries across Asia-Pacific region including Hong Kong, Singapore, Thailand, Malaysia, South Korea, China, the Philippines, Indonesia, Australia, Taiwan, New Zealand, Vietnam, Macau, Cambodia, Brunei, Sri Lanka, India, and Myanmar. As of December 31, 2022, the group served about 41 million individual policies and 17 million participating members of group insurance schemes.

AIA operates through seven business segments: Hong Kong, Thailand, Singapore, Malaysia, Mainland China, Other Markets, and Group Corporate Centre.

Company

Company Name: Manulife (Singapore) Pte Ltd

Manulife (Singapore) Pte Ltd (Manulife Singapore) is an insurance company that offers insurance, retirement, and **wealth management** solutions. The company's insurance products include life insurance, personal, family, health, children, savings, investment, retirement, legacy, family protection, business, and direct insurance products. Its financial solutions comprise **wealth management** solutions, investment linked policy funds summaries and reports, unit trust funds solutions, fund management, and retirement solutions. Manulife Singapore provides economic solutions for regulatory environment. Its funds comprise of Manulife SmartRetire Funds, Manulife InvestReady Funds and Manulife SmartWealth Funds. The company caters to banks, financial advisory firms, individuals, groups, families and corporations. Manulife Singapore is headquartered in Singapore city, Singapore.

Head office: 8 Cross Street 15-01, Manulife Tower, Singapore, Singapore

Website: www.manulife.com.sg

Financial Year End: April

Company Overview

Manulife (Singapore) Pte Ltd (Manulife Singapore) is an insurance company that offers insurance, retirement, and **wealth management** solutions. The company's insurance products include life insurance, personal, family, health, children, savings, investment, retirement, legacy, family protection, business, and direct insurance products. Its financial solutions comprise **wealth management** solutions, investment linked policy funds

summaries and reports, unit trust funds solutions, fund management, and retirement solutions. Manulife Singapore provides economic solutions for regulatory environment. Its funds comprise of Manulife SmartRetire Funds, Manulife InvestReady Funds and Manulife SmartWealth Funds. The company caters to banks, financial advisory firms, individuals, groups, families and corporations. Manulife Singapore is headquartered in Singapore city, Singapore.

Company

Company Name: Prudential Plc

Prudential plc (Prudential) is a financial services group that offers long-term savings and protection products. The group, through its subsidiaries, provides retirement benefits and insurance coverage for various risks such as illness, death and critical life events. It also provides investment solutions across various asset classes, including equities, multi asset, fixed income, infrastructure and alternatives. The group offers its products and services to middle class and ageing population through independent agents, regional broker dealers, independent broker-dealer firms, warehouses and banks. It operates in Asia and Africa. Prudential is headquartered in London, the UK.

The group reported gross premiums earned of US\$23,344 million for the fiscal year ended December 2022 (FY2022), a decrease of 3.6% over that in FY2021. Its net earned premiums were US\$21,401 million in FY2022, a decrease of 4.3% over that in FY2021.

The company reported revenues of (US Dollars) US\$6,997 million for the fiscal year ended December 2022 (FY2022), a decrease of 73.6% over FY2021. The operating loss of the company was US\$558 million in FY2022, compared to an operating profit of US\$2,652 million in FY2021. The net loss of the company was US\$1,007 million in FY2022, compared to a net loss of US\$2,042 million in FY2021.

Head office: 1 Angel Court , London, England, United Kingdom

Telephone: 442075483737

Fax: 442075483725

Number of Employees: 14681

Website: www.prudentialplc.com

Financial Year End: December

Ticker: PRU

Stock Exchange: London Stock Exchange (LON)

Company Overview

Prudential plc (Prudential) is a financial services group that offers long-term savings and protection products. The group, through its subsidiaries, provides retirement benefits and insurance coverage for various risks such as illness, death and critical life events. It also provides investment solutions across various asset classes, including equities, multi asset, fixed income, infrastructure and alternatives. The group offers its products and services to middle class and ageing population through independent agents, regional broker dealers, independent broker-dealer firms, warehouses and banks. It operates in Asia and Africa. Prudential is headquartered in London, the UK.

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Business Description

Prudential plc (Prudential) provides long-term savings and protection products. The group offers retirement savings plans and insurance coverage for various risks such as illness, death, and critical life events. It serves the

middle class and aging population in Asia, and Africa. It serves more than 19 million customers through 530,000 agents, 27,000 bank branches, and 170 bank partners in Asia and Africa.

Prudential classifies its operations into two segments: Insurance and Eastspring

Company

Company Name: The Great Eastern Life Assurance Company Ltd

The Great Eastern Life Assurance Company Ltd (Great Eastern Life), a subsidiary of Singapore-based Great Eastern Holdings Limited, is an insurance company which offers personal and Business insurance products. The company's personal insurance products include Life Insurance, Health Insurance, Personal Accident Insurance, Wealth Accumulation. Its business insurance products comprise general insurance, corporate, employee benefits, workplace benefits, group, portable medical benefits, life accident protection, hospitalization, death, air travel, medical expense, terrorism, and permanent disability insurance, among others. The company offers services such as claims services, financial calculators, and customer support services. Great Eastern Life is headquartered in Singapore.

Head office: #01-01 1 Pickering Street, Great Eastern Center, Singapore, Singapore

Number of Employees: 6000

Website: www.greateasternlife.com

Financial Year End: April

Company Overview

The Great Eastern Life Assurance Company Ltd (Great Eastern Life), a subsidiary of Singapore-based Great Eastern Holdings Limited, is an insurance company which offers personal and Business insurance products. The company's personal insurance products include Life Insurance, Health Insurance, Personal Accident Insurance, Wealth Accumulation. Its business insurance products comprise general insurance, corporate, employee benefits, workplace benefits, group, portable medical benefits, life accident protection, hospitalization, death, air travel, medical expense, terrorism, and permanent disability insurance, among others. The company offers services such as claims services, financial calculators, and customer support services. Great Eastern Life is headquartered in Singapore.

Market Definition

The market is segmented into Life Insurance and Pension/Annuity.

The value of the market is measured in terms of gross premium incomes generated by mortality protection and retirement savings plans. Mortality protection plans provide coverage in the event of death, while retirement savings plans help individuals save for their future.

All market data and forecasts are represented in nominal terms (i.e., without adjustment for inflation) and all currency conversions used in the creation of this report have been calculated using constant 2022 annual average exchange rates.

For the purposes of this report, the global market consists of North America, South America, Europe, Asia-Pacific, Middle East, South Africa and Nigeria.

North America consists of Canada, Mexico, and the United States.

South America comprises Argentina, Brazil, Chile, Colombia, and Peru.

Europe comprises Austria, Belgium, the Czech Republic, Denmark, Finland, France, Germany, Greece, Ireland, Italy, Netherlands, Norway, Poland, Portugal, Russia, Spain, Sweden, Switzerland, Turkey, and the United Kingdom.

Scandinavia comprises Denmark, Finland, Norway, and Sweden.

Asia-Pacific comprises Australia, China, Hong Kong, India, Indonesia, Kazakhstan, Japan, Malaysia, New Zealand, Pakistan, Philippines, Singapore, South Korea, Taiwan, Thailand, and Vietnam.

Middle East comprises Egypt, Israel, Saudi Arabia, and United Arab Emirates.

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413 words
10 November 2023
Business Day
MEWBUD
Business Day

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English
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PERSONAL BANKING HSBC eyes India high-net-worths

ReutersMumbai HSBC aims to expand its personal banking services in India to serve the country's fast-growing pool of high-earning professionals, after the launch there in July of its **private bank**.

In addition to **wealth management** services offered by the new **private bank**, the business will provide digital credit cards and personal loans to well-off customers, Hitendra Dave said in an interview with Reuters on Thursday.

The bank has long had a retail, or personal, banking business in India, but did not focus on building it up, said Dave.

"What has changed in the last three years is that the target market for HSBC in India has exploded," he said. "We intend to build a very large retail, or what we call a personal, banking business."

HSBC's new **private banking** business in India, part of a wider focus on Asian **wealth management**, targets rich customers, typically defined as those with a net worth of more than \$30m.

Beyond the most affluent, HSBC will target a rising number of Indian professionals, whose earnings and spending capacity rose significantly over the past few years, said Dave.

For this segment, HSBC will launch a "digital card issuance programme" and a digital loan product "fairly soon", in addition to its mortgage loans.

The number of high-net-worth individuals — those with an asset value of more than \$1m — is seen to be more than doubling from 2022 to reach 1.65-million by 2027.

The retail banking push will mean more investment in technology and expansion of the bank's branch network, said Dave. "We intend to build a profitable business," he said.

HSBC India reported a profit before tax of \$766m in the six months to June 30 2023, up from \$645m in the matching period a year ago.

Global banking markets and commercial banking are the largest contributors to the business in India.

HSBC India's wealth and personal banking segment, which includes **private banking**, mortgages and asset management, contributed \$35m or 4.6% to its profit before tax in the first six months of 2023.

On the institutional side HSBC will grow investment banking, including through senior hires in trying to increase cross-border fundraising and merger activity as global interest in the Indian economy rises, said Dave. Reuters

Range: In addition to **wealth management** services the new **private bank** will provide digital credit cards and personal loans.Reuters

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HSBC eyes India high-net-worths

Reuters

389 words

10 November 2023

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English

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Mumbai

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THE STRAITS TIMES

Straits Times Breaking News

Business

OCBC Q3 profit up 21% to \$1.81 billion amid record net interest income

Prisca Ang

627 words

10 November 2023

The Straits Times

STIMES

English

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SINGAPORE - OCBC Bank on Friday posted third-quarter earnings that were boosted by record net interest income on the back of high rates, and growth in **wealth management** and credit card fees.

The net profit of Singapore's second-largest bank rose 21 per cent year on year to \$1.81 billion, in line with estimates by analysts in a Refinitiv poll.

For the first nine months, OCBC's net profit grew 32 per cent to a new high of \$5.4 billion, marking the first time it had crossed \$5 billion for the period.

OCBC's results wrap up Singapore banks' earnings season, with largest lender DBS on Monday posting a 16 per cent year-on-year rise in third-quarter net profit to \$2.59 billion, and UOB on Oct 26 reporting a 5 per cent increase in core earnings to \$1.48 billion.

Although rising interest rates have lifted margins, they also mean that lenders will have to grapple with reduced demand for loans, adding on to other challenges in the global environment.

OCBC group chief executive Helen Wong said that looking ahead, macroeconomic conditions are expected to be clouded by growing uncertainties from inflationary risks, tightening monetary policies and heightened geopolitical risks.

"Nonetheless, with our robust funding, liquidity and capital positions, we are confident of the group's ability to deliver sustainable value to our stakeholders," she said.

OCBC's third-quarter net interest income rose 17 per cent to a new high of \$2.46 billion. It was driven by 6 per cent asset growth and a 21-basis point increase in net interest margin - a key gauge of a bank's profitability - to 2.27 per cent.

Loans grew 1 per cent in constant currency terms to \$298 billion.

Non-interest income rose 4 per cent to \$973 million as higher fee income and improved investment performance offset lower insurance income.

Net fee income rose 2 per cent to \$461 million - the highest level recorded in the past four quarters - largely due to higher credit card fees and a growth in **wealth management** fees from increased customer activities.

Net trading income, mainly comprising customer flow treasury income, was stable year on year at \$216 million.

Profit from the bank's insurance arm Great Eastern Holdings stood at \$220 million, down 12 per cent from a year ago, largely due to an increase in medical claims which was partly compensated by improved investment performance. More On This Topic DBS had \$100m exposure to money laundering bust; Q3 profit of \$2.63b beats forecasts UOB sees stronger loan and fee growth in 2024; Q3 core net profit up 5%

Meanwhile, the bank saw greater inflows of net new money. Assets under management in its **wealth management** business expanded 8 per cent to \$270 billion as at Sept 30.

Its total **wealth management** income, which comprises income from businesses such as insurance, private banking, asset management and stockbroking, grew 16 per cent to \$1.12 billion.

Operating expenses rose 5 per cent to \$1.34 billion on the back of continued investments in people and technology. Income growth outpaced the increase in expenses, resulting in an improvement of the group's cost-to-income ratio to 39.1 per cent, compared with 42.2 per cent in the previous year.

Total allowances set aside for potential bad loans were \$184 million, compared with \$154 million a year ago, largely due to higher specific provisions. However, the bank wrote back or restored to profit \$36 million in general allowances.

The bank's non-performing loan ratio improved to 1 per cent, from 1.2 per cent a year ago.

Document STIMES0020231110ejba0008e

Exclusive: HSBC GPB adds NRI banker

Priyanka Boghani

213 words

3 November 2023

Citywire Asia

CWIRAS

English

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HSBC Global **Private Banking** has added to its stable of **private bankers**, with the hire of a non-resident Indian (NRI) and Middle East and North Africa banker.

Manish Vyas has joined the bank's team, based in Hong Kong. He reports to Abhishek Mehrotra on an entity basis and Gary Goh on a functional basis.

A spokesperson from the bank confirmed his hire.

Vyas was most recently at Hong Kong-based wealth management firm, Winland Wealth, which is helmed by former Coutts banker Keith Wong.

Vyas also worked at Credit Suisse, Coutts and ICICI Bank.

HSBC Global **Private Banking** has a [new](#) Asia CEO, with Lok Yim stepping in from Deutsche Bank and officially starting on a designate basis on 1 November, following Siew Meng Tan's decision to retire.

Earlier this year, the **private bank** [snapped](#) up senior **private banker**, Hemant Geriani from Standard Chartered **Private Bank** to look after the global India business. Geriani is based in Singapore and reports to Manoj Ramarao, head of global India business, who joined in February from EFG.

According to HSBC's latest third quarter earnings, Asia [drew](#) in \$42bn in net new invested assets for the bank, accounting for more than half of its \$67bn total.

Document CWIRAS0020231103ejb300002

Exclusive: Former StanChart ASEAN deputy market head resurfaces at UBP

Priyanka Boghani

215 words

24 October 2023

Citywire Asia

CWIRAS

English

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A former Standard Chartered **Private Bank** ASEAN deputy market head has resurfaced at UBP in a similar role, according to a note seen by Citywire Asia.

Lawrence Goh has joined UBP as market head of ASEAN, based in Singapore. He reports to Eric Morin, head of region Southeast Asia and CEO of Singapore.

'In line with our selective hiring strategy directed towards the most experienced **private bankers** in Asia, we are delighted to welcome Lawrence to UBP. 2023 will have seen a steady increase in the number of bankers based in UBP Singapore.

'Lawrence's arrival confirms the attractiveness of our franchise for senior bankers looking for a strong bank providing a compelling value proposition for family offices and UHNWI in Southeast Asia,' said Morin about the appointment.

A spokesperson from the bank confirmed the contents of the note.

Goh joins from Standard Chartered **Private Bank**, having joined it at deputy market head for ASEAN in 2021. Before that, he worked at Bank of Singapore.

Indeed, UBP has been on a hiring spree in both Hong Kong and Singapore, adding senior bankers of the likes of Jennie Hananto, Chaitanya Komaravalli, Yi Min Tse and Andrew Chin, along with a raft of relationship managers.

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FINANCIAL REVIEW

Companies and Markets

Extreme wealth: HSBC joins cash trail to the uber rich in Australia

Primrose Riordan and Aaron Weinman

619 words

21 October 2023

The Australian Financial Review

AFNR

First

29

English

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HSBC is relocating **private bankers** from Singapore to Australia as Wall Street returns in force to try to bank more of the country's ultra-high net worth individuals and secretive **family offices**.

The shake-up comes as the nation's **family office** ranks swell, while a shrinking ASX, higher interest rates and a weaker Australian dollar have prompted wealthy individuals to look beyond domestic investment ideas.

Adam Seward, one of HSBC's top **private bankers** covering Australian clients, will relocate to Sydney from Singapore next year, people familiar with the matter say. At least two more relationship advisers are headed to Australia.

"Our booking centre and specialists support, including investments and credit, will continue to be based in Singapore," Jessica Power, HSBC's head of wealth and personal banking for Australia, told AFR Weekend.

In response to questions about the reallocation of advisers to Australia, Sydney-based Ms Power said HSBC "regularly" reviewed resources, which included internal relocations.

Australia's **wealth management** space has undergone significant changes this year, with global investment banks altering their approach to managing the money of the country's wealthiest people.

Credit Suisse's shotgun wedding with former rival UBS has meant the Swiss institution will return to the local **wealth management** scene after it departed in 2015 through a management buyout.

LGT Crestone - the result of the aforementioned buyout - is also expanding. It hired seven executives from rival private **wealth management** firm Escala Partners, Street Talk first reported in September.

Industry sources said Crestone was in a better position to take market share because it now had access to the Liechtenstein royal family-backed LGT's balance sheet. LGT Crestone lost access to the UBS' analyst research, indicative of an intensifying rivalry.

Goldman Sachs, too, beefed up its **wealth management** team to 12 advisers from six, Simon Rothery, the US investment bank's local chief executive, said in July. Five of the six new advisers moved from other positions at Goldman.

Investment bank JPMorgan also appointed Singapore-based Arun Chandramouli to lead its Australian **private bank** after Oliver Bareau exited in August. Mr Chandramouli joins relationship manager Lavanya Rajalingam.

"We see the significant opportunities that the Australia market presents and we continue to explore how best ... [to] invest in further growth of the business," JPMorgan said.

Global lenders have flittered in and out of Australia's **wealth management** space over the years, expanding, and then repatriating staff to regional hubs in Asia.

"International investment banks find it difficult to make money here - Australians love cash and real estate," one long-time **private banker** said, pointing to the general perception that wealthy Australians remain reluctant to diversify their portfolios beyond tried-and-tested sectors.

For investment banks with **wealth management** arms, Hong Kong, Singapore and fast-growing South-East Asian nations have been more appealing because of their sheer numbers of millionaires and billionaires.

But Australia, which is the top global destination for inflows of high net worth individuals, has now become more attractive. Australia's **family offices** - KPMG estimates there are 2000 - have become more sophisticated.

The cheaper Australian dollar, smaller ASX and the collapse in commercial property prices had made wealthy Australians concerned about having too much wealth concentrated domestically, bankers said.

The Wall Street banks are honing in on Australia's ultra-wealthy with slim teams. Goldman's 12 advisers take on clients with more than \$100 million in investible assets, while JPMorgan targets individuals with \$25 million.

Morgan Stanley in July began offering clients with less than \$1 million the chance to move their **wealth management** services to Ord Minnett.

Document AFNR000020231023ejal0001e

Companies

StanChart appoints two private banking heads

Mia, StanChart appoints two private banking heads

243 words

21 October 2023

Business Times Singapore

STBT

English

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STANDARD Chartered (StanChart) has appointed veteran banker Foo Tian Ong as regional head of South-east Asia and Singapore head of private banking, with effect from December.

With over two decades of private-banking experience, Foo will be joining the bank from UBS, where his most recent role was business sector head for various markets including Thailand, the Philippines and Vietnam, said StanChart on Friday (Oct 20).

Separately, StanChart has expanded Vinay Gandhi's role to cover a wider region as global head of South Asian community and regional head of Africa, Middle East and Europe under the private-banking segment. His new appointment will be effective from the start of 2024. The bank noted that Gandhi has led robust growth in Singapore's private-banking business as regional head of Asean and global head of South Asian community over the past two years.

Raymond Ang, global head of private and affluent banking at StanChart, said that the reshuffle of the bank's management in wealth planning and corporate solutions partners space is intended to strengthen the bank's proposition for clients, with added experiences to the senior bench.

In September this year, the bank appointed Mike Tan as global head of wealth planning and family advisory.

Fred Leung joined as head of solutions partners earlier this year, leading the corporate solutions segment for ultra-high-net-worth individuals globally.

Document STBT000020231020ejal002mx

Standard Chartered **Private Bank** strengthens leadership team

Distributed by Contify.com

589 words

20 October 2023

Contify Banking News

ATINBK

English

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Standard Chartered Bank has appointed Vinay Gandhi as Global Head of South Asian Community and Regional Head of Africa, Middle East, and Europe, **Private Banking**. Vinay has led the bank's **private banking** business in Singapore to robust growth over the past two years. In his expanded role, he will spearhead one of the bank's largest businesses with significant growth potential. Vinay's appointment is effective from January 1, 2024. Additionally, Foo Tian Ong has been appointed as Regional Head, Southeast Asia, and Singapore Location Head, **Private Banking**. Tian Ong brings over two decades of **private banking** experience and will join the bank in December 2023. These appointments strengthen the bank's senior bench strength and support its ambition to grow its Affluent business. Raymond Ang, Global Head of Private & Affluent Banking, expressed confidence that these appointments will enhance the bank's proposition for clients and contribute to its goal of becoming a leading wealth manager.

Original Press Release:

Singapore, Oct. 20 -- Standard Chartered issued the following news release:

Standard Chartered Bank ("the Bank") has appointed Vinay Gandhi as Global Head of South Asian Community and Regional Head of Africa, Middle East and Europe, **Private Banking**.

The Bank's **private banking** business in Singapore has witnessed robust growth under Vinay's leadership over the past two years. In this expanded role, Vinay will be responsible for an increased mandate to spearhead one of our largest businesses that offers a significant growth opportunity. His new appointment is effective from 1 January 2024.

Foo Tian Ong is appointed Regional Head, Southeast Asia and Singapore Location Head, **Private Banking**. Tian Ong will be based in Singapore when he joins the Bank in December 2023.

Tian Ong is a well-respected veteran **private banker** in this region. He brings more than two decades of **private banking** experience, joining Standard Chartered from UBS where he was most recently Business Sector Head for Thailand and the Philippines, and was also responsible for NRI and Vietnam. Before UBS, Tian Ong honed his banking career in corporate banking, institutional equities sales and research at leading financial institutions, with a special focus on the Thai market.

Last month, Mike Tan joined the Bank as Global Head, Wealth Planning & Family Advisory. Earlier this year, Fred Leung joined as Head, Solutions Partners, to lead the delivery of one-bank corporate solutions for UHNW clients globally. These appointments add to the senior bench strength of the **private banking** business, supporting the Bank's ambition to grow its Affluent business.

Commenting on the appointments, Raymond Ang, Global Head, Private & Affluent Banking, said: "These senior appointments focused on ASEAN, South Asia, Africa & Middle East and in the Wealth Planning and Corporate Solutions Partners space add a wealth of experience to Standard Chartered. Their leadership will strengthen our proposition for clients and bolster our ambition to be a leading wealth manager across our footprint."

Standard Chartered

We are a leading international banking group, with a presence in 53 of the world's most dynamic markets, and serving clients in a further 64. Our purpose is to drive commerce and prosperity through our unique diversity, and our heritage and values are expressed in our brand promise, here for good.

Standard Chartered PLC is listed on the London and Hong Kong Stock Exchanges.

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For more stories and expert opinions please visit Insights at [sc.com](https://www.sc.com). Follow Standard Chartered on Twitter, LinkedIn and Facebook.

Source: Standard Chartered

[Category: Banks, Banks, Retail/ Commercial Bank, Management Changes]

Document ATINBK0020231101ejak0008m

Exclusive: StanChart names Foo SE Asia head, with Gandhi taking wider role

James Phillipps
232 words
20 October 2023
Citywire Asia
CWIRAS
English

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Standard Chartered Bank has named recently hired UBS Global Wealth Management star banker Foo Tian Ong as regional head, Southeast Asia and Singapore location head, with Vinay Gandhi set to take on a wider remit.

In a reshuffle of its leadership team, previous Singapore private banking boss Gandhi has been appointed global head of South Asian community and regional head of Africa, Middle East and Europe, private banking from 1 January next year.

Foo (pictured), whose hire was [revealed by Citywire Asia](#) last month, will join SCB in December. He was previously the Singapore-based head of Thailand and Philippines at UBS GWM.

SCB also hired Mike Tan as global head, wealth planning & family advisory and Fred Leung as head, solutions partners last month to lead its one-bank corporate solutions proposition.

Raymond Ang, global head of private & affluent banking, said: 'These senior appointments focused on Asean, South Asia, Africa & Middle East and in the wealth planning and corporate solutions partners space add a wealth of experience to Standard Chartered. Their leadership will strengthen our proposition for clients and bolster our ambition to be a leading wealth manager across our footprint.'

The bank additionally [reorganised its Southeast team](#) last month after two departures, with Vijai Krovvidi becoming Southeast Asia market head, and also overhauled its [non-resident Indian](#) team.

Document CWIRAS0020231020ejak00001

FINANCIAL REVIEW

Financial services

Beyond cash and property: HSBC joins fight for Australia's ultra-rich

Primrose Riordan and Aaron Weinman

650 words

20 October 2023

05:00

AFR Online

AFNROL

English

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HSBC is relocating **private bankers** from Singapore to Australia as Wall Street returns in force to try to bank more of the country's ultra-high net worth individuals and secretive **family offices**.

The shake-up comes as the nation's **family office** ranks swell, while [a shrinking ASX](#), higher interest rates and a weaker Australian dollar have prompted wealthy individuals to look beyond domestic investment ideas.

Adam Seward, one of HSBC's top **private bankers** covering Australian clients, will relocate to Sydney from Singapore next year, people familiar with the matter say. At least two more relationship advisers are headed to Australia.

"Our booking centre and specialists support, including investments and credit, will continue to be based in Singapore," Jessica Power, HSBC's head of wealth and personal banking for Australia, told AFR Weekend.

In response to questions about the reallocation of advisers to Australia, Sydney-based Ms Power said HSBC "regularly" reviewed resources, which included internal relocations.

Australia's **wealth management** space has undergone significant changes this year, with global investment banks altering their approach to managing the money of the country's wealthiest people.

Credit Suisse's [shotgun wedding](#) with former rival UBS has meant the Swiss institution will return to the local **wealth management** scene after it departed in 2015 through a [management buyout](#).

LGT Crestone – the result of the aforementioned buyout – is also expanding. It hired seven executives from rival private **wealth management** firm Escala Partners, Street Talk [first reported](#) in September.

Industry sources said Crestone was in a better position to take market share because it now had access to the Liechtenstein royal family-backed LGT's balance sheet. LGT Crestone [lost access](#) to the UBS' analyst research, indicative of an intensifying rivalry.

Goldman Sachs, too, beefed up its **wealth management** team to 12 advisers from six, Simon Rothery, the US investment bank's local chief executive, [said](#) in July. Five of the six new advisers moved from other positions at Goldman.

Investment bank JPMorgan also appointed Singapore-based Arun Chandramouli to lead its Australian **private bank** after Oliver Bareau exited in August. Mr Chandramouli joins relationship manager Lavanya Rajalingam.

"We see the significant opportunities that the Australia market presents and we continue to explore how best ... [to] invest in further growth of the business," JPMorgan said.

Global lenders have flittered in and out of Australia's **wealth management** space over the years, expanding, and then repatriating staff back to regional hubs in Asia.

Reluctant to diversify

"International investment banks find it difficult to make money here – Australians love cash and real estate," one long-time **private banker** said, pointing to the general perception that wealthy Australians remain reluctant to diversify their portfolios beyond tried-and-tested sectors.

The banker added that the country's richest were also incentivised to invest locally, rather than globally.

For investment banks with **wealth management** arms, Hong Kong, Singapore and fast-growing South-East Asian nations have been more appealing because of their sheer numbers of millionaires and billionaires.

But Australia, which is the top global destination for inflows of high net worth individuals, has now become more attractive. Australia's **family offices** – KPMG estimates there are 2000 – have become more sophisticated, and some employ former investment bankers open to international investments.

The cheaper Australian dollar, smaller ASX and the collapse in commercial property prices had made wealthy Australians concerned about having too much wealth concentrated domestically, bankers said.

The Wall Street banks are honing in on Australia's ultra-wealthy with slim teams. Goldman's 12 advisers take on clients with more than \$100 million in investible assets, while JPMorgan targets individuals with \$25 million.

Morgan Stanley in July began offering clients with less than \$1 million the chance to [move their **wealth management**](#) services to Ord Minnett.

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Document AFNROL0020231022ejaj0015p

HSBC acquires Citi's \$3.6bn consumer wealth portfolio in China

Shruti Khairnar

315 words

10 October 2023

FinTech Futures News

FTEFN

English

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HSBC has agreed to purchase Citi's retail wealth management portfolio in China, including deposits and investment assets under management (AUM) worth \$3.6 billion.

[HSBC is set to buy Citi's consumer wealth business in China](#)

While terms of the transaction remain undisclosed, the deal is expected to close in the first half of 2024, with HSBC Bank China planning to extend employment offers to "in-scope employees".

Describing the deal as an "excellent outcome" for Citi's China clients and consumer wealth colleagues, Titi Cole, Citi's head of legacy franchises, says: "We are taking important steps forward in exiting our consumer banking business in China and continue to make progress in our divestitures as part of our strategy to simplify Citi."

Citi adds that the sale does not include its institutional businesses in China, claiming it holds a "leading position" in that area, and that it aims to continue serving China's ultra-high net worth individuals through regional hubs in Singapore and Hong Kong.

Strategic refresh

The deal follows Citi's move to wind-down its consumer banking business in China, which was announced in December 2022. The bank first announced its plan to exit China's consumer banking market in April 2021.

In September 2022, Citi had announced its intention to [exit consumer banking](#) across 14 markets in Asia, Europe, the Middle East and Mexico as part of a global "strategic refresh".

So far, it has closed sales in eight markets including Australia, Bahrain, India, Malaysia, the Philippines, [Taiwan](#), Thailand and Vietnam, with plans to close the sale of its Indonesia consumer business later this year.

Citi adds that its wind-downs in Korea and Russia are "in progress" and that it plans on pursuing an IPO of its consumer, small business and middle market banking operations in Mexico.

Document FTEFN00020231010ejaa0008d

HSBC Global **Private Banking** Announces Leadership Transition for Middle East & North Africa and Strengthens Teams in Qatar, Israel, Switzerland

Distributed by Contify.com

895 words

2 October 2023

Contify Banking News

ATINBK

English

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HSBC has announced a leadership transition in its Global **Private Banking** Middle East & North Africa (MENA) division. Aladdin Hangari has been appointed as the new Head of Global **Private Banking** MENA, succeeding Sobhi Tabbara who will be leaving HSBC in January 2024. Sobhi has been leading the MENA region since 2012, expanding its Ultra-High-Net-Worth coverage in key markets. To ensure a smooth transition, Sobhi and Aladdin will serve as co-Heads of MENA until January. Aladdin joins HSBC from Credit Suisse, where he held various leadership positions. HSBC will also strengthen its coverage in Qatar with the appointment of Patrick D'Amico as Global Market Head of Qatar, along with other relationship managers.

Key Highlights:

* Sobhi Tabbara is leaving HSBC in January 2024 to pursue opportunities outside the bank.

* Sobhi Tabbara has been leading HSBC Global **Private Banking** in the MENA region since 2012.

* Sobhi Tabbara has driven the expansion of Ultra-High-Net-Worth (UHNW) coverage in key markets such as Saudi Arabia, the UAE, Qatar, Kuwait, and Bahrain.

Original Press Release:

Geneva, Oct. 2 -- HSBC issued the following news release:

HSBC announces the appointment of Aladdin Hangari as Head of Global **Private Banking** Middle East & North Africa (MENA), succeeding Sobhi Tabbara who has announced his departure from HSBC with effect from January 2024 to pursue opportunities beyond the bank.

Sobhi has led HSBC Global **Private Banking** in the MENA region since 2012, driving the expansion of its Ultra-High-Net-Worth (UHNW) coverage in key markets, including Saudi Arabia, the UAE, Qatar, Kuwait and Bahrain. To ensure a seamless transition, Sobhi and Aladdin will serve as co-Heads of MENA until January.

Aladdin joins HSBC from Credit Suisse, where he spent 20 years, most recently as CEO of Credit Suisse (Qatar LLC) and CEO of Aventicum Capital Management Holding AG. He will play a critical role in continuing HSBC Global **Private Banking**'s success across all countries of the Gulf Cooperation Council, building on the strong foundations laid by Sobhi which has seen the **private bank** establish a leading presence across the region, connecting clients to international opportunities.

HSBC will also strengthen its coverage of Qatar with the appointment of Patrick D'Amico as Global Market Head of Qatar, joining from Credit Suisse. Christian Hiller, Thomas Schaad and Simon Aeschlimann are joining the Qatar team from Credit Suisse as Relationship Managers. They will be based in Switzerland and integrated with HSBC's established Qatari desk based onshore in Qatar.

To further strengthen its offer in Switzerland, HSBC announces the appointment of Kouroche Achtari as Market Head for International Switzerland, joining from Credit Suisse. This appointment sees HSBC enhancing its coverage for Swiss-based UHNW clients and family offices with an international footprint. Similarly, in Israel, the bank welcomes Roy Mironi to its ranks who joins from Deutsche Bank as its new Desk Head of Israel, reporting to Oren Ben Ishay, Market Head of Israel & Head of Tel Aviv Rep Office.

HSBC Global **Private Banking** continues to strengthen its position across the region, serving customers with excellence throughout Europe and the Middle East. Over the past 12 months the bank has launched an onshore

business in the UAE, an onshore advisory service in Kuwait, and strengthened its coverage of Saudi Arabia, Qatar, Israel, Italy, Northern Europe and Switzerland, complementing its existing regional teams serving individuals, families and entrepreneurs worldwide.

Gabriel Castello, Regional Head of Global **Private Banking** EMEA and CEO of the Swiss **Private Bank**, said: "We are extremely pleased to welcome Aladdin and our new colleagues to our ranks, all of whom will be instrumental in continuing our exceptional client service, connecting clients to unique opportunities and tailor-made solutions worldwide. Further strengthening our service across Europe, the Middle East and Africa underlines HSBC's extensive heritage and reaffirms our position as a leading **private bank** in the region.

"I would also like to pay tribute to Sobhi's remarkable achievements and thank him for his valuable contribution to HSBC during his 36 years with the bank, where his leadership and vision has been instrumental in building out our impressive portfolio across the Middle East and designing our compelling client offer. His dedication and service has been truly appreciated and we wish him all the best in his future endeavours."

Global **Private Banking**

HSBC Global **Private Banking** provides banking, investment and wealth management solutions for individuals, families, business owners, entrepreneurs and investors. Their ambitions and the decisions they make today can shape the world of tomorrow and we help our clients grow, manage and preserve their wealth, now and across generations.

With our international network and breadth of services, we connect clients to meaningful opportunities worldwide. We provide wealth planning and family governance services, while our experts in philanthropy support clients in their ambition to have a positive impact on society. For more information, visit www.privatebanking.hsbc.com.

About HSBC

HSBC Holdings plc, the parent company of HSBC, is headquartered in London. HSBC serves customers worldwide from offices in 62 countries and territories. With assets of USD3,041 billion at 30 June 2023, HSBC is one of the world's largest banking and financial services organisations.

Source: HSBC

[Category: Banks, Banks, Retail/ Commercial Bank, Management Changes]

Document ATINBK0020231003eja2000dx

HSBC strengthens EMEA team with Credit Suisse private bankers

Margaryta Kirakosian

391 words

2 October 2023

Citywire Asia

CWIRAS

English

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HSBC has confirmed the appointment of Aladdin Hangari as head of global private banking Middle East and North Africa (Mena), following media reports about his switch from Credit Suisse this summer.

Hangari is succeeding Sobhi Tabbara, who has led Mena banking for the firm since 2012. In this role, he drove ultra-high-net-worth (UHNW) coverage expansion across key markets, including Saudi Arabia, the UAE, Qatar, Kuwait and Bahrain. He will leave HSBC in January 2024.

Hangari spent 20 years at Credit Suisse, most recently as CEO of Qatar business and CEO of Aventicum Capital Management Holding.

Another former senior Credit Suisse banker to join HSBC is Patrick D'Amico, who will be global market head of Qatar.

He arrived together with former Credit Suisse relationship managers Christian Hiller, Thomas Schaad and Simon Aeschlimann, who will be members of the Qatar team based in Switzerland. They will be integrated into HSBC's established onshore Qatari desk.

Senior Swiss moves

Elsewhere, HSBC has made another Credit Suisse hire for Switzerland, where Kouroche Achtari is taking on the role of market head for international Switzerland to enhance the bank's coverage of UHNW clients and family offices.

Another newcomer is Roy Mironi, who joins from Deutsche Bank as its new desk head of Israel, reporting to Oren Ben Ishay, market head of Israel and head of its Tel Aviv rep office.

These are the latest senior hires that HSBC has made for its EMEA private banking franchise. So far, it has strengthened its coverage of Saudi Arabia, Qatar, Israel, Italy, Northern Europe and Switzerland with hires from UBS, Credit Suisse and Lombard Odier.

The bank also launched an onshore business in the UAE and an onshore advisory service in Kuwait in the last 12 months.

HSBC currently has 200 relationship managers in EMEA and manages €153bn (\$160bn) in private banking assets in the region.

Speaking to Citywire earlier this year, Gabriel Castello, regional head of global private banking EMEA and CEO of Swiss private banking, talked about his expansion plans and the role that corporate banking and lending capabilities play in attracting UHNW clients to the bank.

The latest hires are among a series of newcomers from Credit Suisse, which included a team that joined HSBC in London to focus on financial services clients.

Document CWIRAS0020231003eja200005



HSBC plans buying Citigroup's consumer wealth biz in China - report

192 words

29 September 2023

13:28

SeeNews Banking

SEBNK

English

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September 29 (SeeNews) - Britain's HSBC Holdings Plc (LON:HSBA) is planning to take over the China consumer **wealth management** business of US investment bank Citigroup, Reuters reported on Thursday citing unnamed sources.

The deal, if executed, will see the UK bank acquire a business with over USD 3 billion (EUR 2.85bn) worth of assets under management, along with over "a few hundreds" of Citi's China-based employees. According to the insiders, the transaction could be made public as soon as next month.

Through its China **wealth management** operations, Citigroup mostly serves wealthy customers by offering deposit, fund and structured products. The business is part of the US group's retail banking unit.

HSBC, which is sourcing a significant portion from its revenues from Asia, is in the process of boosting its Chinese activities as it aims to put a greater focus on the lucrative Asian market. The lender already provides **wealth management** and private banking services in China, where it allegedly plans to launch fund sales through its insurance brokerage network from next month.

(USD 1.0 = EUR 0.951)

Document SEBNK00020230929ej9t0002t

Business

HSBC to buy Citigroup China consumer wealth business

Reuters

322 words

28 September 2023

RTE.ie

RTEI

English

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HSBC is set to acquire Citigroup's China consumer wealth management business, which manages more than \$3 billion in assets, two sources with knowledge of the matter said.

The deal will come as a major boost for the London-based bank's business in China.

The transaction, the financial details of which were not immediately known, will also see Asia-focussed HSBC taking over "a few hundreds" of Citi's China-based staff, said one of the sources.

The deal could be announced as soon as next month, the two sources said, who could not be named as they were not authorised to speak to the media.

The acquisition adds to a list of moves by HSBC to expand in China, one of its key markets as Europe's largest lender vows to exit less profitable geographies to focus on its key revenue generator, Asia.

Citi's China wealth management operations, part of the retail banking business it has been looking to exit since 2021, mainly serves mass affluent clients in the world's second-largest economy.

Its private banking services, catering to high net worth Chinese clients from the bank's locations outside of China, remains intact, the first source said.

Citi is also in the process of applying to set up a China securities brokerage unit.

Citi said in December it was looking to sell some of its portfolios as it wound down its China retail banking business, part of a strategy to withdraw from consumer franchises in 14 markets in Asia, Europe, the Middle East, Africa and Mexico.

In Asia, Citi is in the process of closing its South Korea operation and plans to complete transferring its Indonesian business to UOB Group.

In August, it completed the sale and migration of its Taiwan consumer businesses.

[Today's acquisition adds to a list of moves by HSBC to expand in China](#)

Document RTEI000020230928ej9s0008j

Current Account

Spotlight: 'Universal banks will do better than standalone boutique wealth management firms'

NARAYANAN V

775 words

24 September 2023

BusinessLine Online

BSNLNO

English

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Nitin Chengappa, MD and Head, Affluent, **Private Bank** and Branch Network, and Pankaj Walia, Head of **Private Banking**, Standard Chartered Bank, India explain why India is a key **private banking** market. Edited excerpts:

Standard Chartered Bank India seems gung-ho about India's private wealth business?

Chengappa: We have a pyramid-like structure starting with regular banking, premium banking, priority banking and, on top of all, the **private banking** focusses on high networth individuals (HNIs), Ultra HNIs, billionaires and family offices. If you look at global data, the fastest growth of HNIs is happening in India, and that's why we recently launched exclusive **private banking** centres in Kolkata and Chennai, taking it to five centres in India. We are also planning to expand in Kerala, Hyderabad and Gujarat in the next one year.

A lot of other foreign banks and Indian banks are also focussing on the **private banking** space?

Chengappa: Because that's a sweet spot now. However, foreign banks have two big advantages vis-a-vis a PSU or a private sector bank. First, we have the unique strength of offering an international solution, which nobody can. For example, if a HNI has an account in India as well as in the UAE, he can see both sides of the corridors with our solution.

Second, rich clients look for a lot of diversification opportunities. With the Liberalised Remittance Scheme, there is more receptiveness today to look at global investment opportunities. We see flows happening significantly out of the country for property-related investments or plain vanilla dollar-based investments. These unique characteristics are available only with the global banks.

How do you see the competition from standalone wealth management firms?

Walia: The key differentiator between us and a standalone boutique **private bank** is that we operate as an universal bank. Very few customers want a standalone wealth solution. Our franchise and 'One Bank' approach can support a client on his wealth needs, corporate banking, as well as offer international banking. We are present in about 42 cities with 100-plus branches. Look at Asia. Of the top 4 **private banks**, two are universal banks, and two are standalone **private banks**. I strongly feel, in the next five years, universal banks will do much better than standalone boutique **private banks**, because clients are looking for a trusted advisor, who can also give them comprehensive banking solutions.

What are the asset classes that HNIs are interested in?

Walia: Private credit market is extremely hot and most clients want to look at this space. Most HNIs and family offices have professionals and ex-bankers with, so they are also doing their own due diligence to evaluate the risk-reward proposition in the private credit space. Venture capital is another important area. They want to get into a company at an early stage or in the second or third round, whenever they get an opportunity.

How is the NRI business doing for Standard Chartered?

Chengappa: It is the fastest-growing segment, and we have been growing 35 per cent year-on-year in that business. As a brand, we have a very strong presence in Asia, West Asia and Africa. For an NRI, that's the first comfort for sending money into a country. Even from a market standpoint, if you really want to make money as an NRI, which market gives you better returns today than India?

Walia: Wherever NRIs stay, they typically have about 60-65 per cent of their assets there. About 12-13 per cent will be invested in onshore India, and the balance in other global markets. That onshore India opportunity is huge. While NRIs are trying to build overseas, an equal or even larger number of NRI families want to invest in the India growth story.

What is the contribution of **private banking** to overall revenues of the bank?

Chengappa: **Private banking** contributed 15 per cent of the 'affluent business' of Standard Chartered Bank India's total revenues in 2022. It is expected to grow to 25-30 percent in the next 3-4 years.

How big is the **private banking** arm of Standard Chartered Bank, India?

Walia: We started **private banking** operations in 2008. We currently manage close to \$12 billion of assets under management of our clients in the onshore India market. We currently have 900 UHNIs and billionaire clients, who are managed by 32 most experienced and most vintage senior bankers. We expect consistent growth in our AUMs over next 3-4 years in the range of 10 per cent annually.

Document BSNLNO0020230924ej9o000un

Exclusive: HSBC's global chief information officer for wealth and private banking exits

Priyanka Boghani

207 words

19 September 2023

Citywire Asia

CWIRAS

English

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HSBC's chief information officer across its wealth and private banking operations has left the bank, Citywire Asia understands.

Manoj Bhojwani has left his role at the bank after over five years, where he led technology teams across the wealth and global private banking businesses. Anil Venuturupalli, the bank's global private banking and wealth management chief operating officer will take on Bhojwani's responsibilities in an expanded role.

A spokesperson for the bank declined to comment.

Bhojwani was HSBC's regional retail banking wealth management and private banking chief information officer for three years, based in Hong Kong, before he moved to Singapore to take on the global role in 2020. He reported to Gavin Munroe, global chief information officer, wealth, and personal banking.

During his stint at HSBC, Bhojwani oversaw several technology initiatives including the addition of fixed coupon notes to its online trading platform for mobile users last year.

Prior to HSBC, Bhojwani spent close to a decade at Credit Suisse where he had two different roles, including head of Asia private banking IT. He was also part of the bank's large digital private banking rollout in the region.

Document CWIRAS0020230919ej9j00004

The Telegraph

Standard Chartered Bank inaugurates private banking centre in Chennai

121 words

19 September 2023

The Telegraph

ABPTEL

English

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Standard Chartered Bank has inaugurated its private banking centre in Chennai, the over-century-old bank said on Saturday.

The centre is the fifth after Bangalore, New Delhi, Calcutta and Mumbai.

Aimed at serving high-net-worth and ultra-high-net-worth clients, the centre offers products, advisory, and insights to manage, grow, and protect personal and business wealth.

"Being one of the oldest global banks in India, we have relationships across multi-generations.

"Therefore, we can focus both on a traditional approach while offering bespoke, objective, and holistic advice supported by an open architecture platform," said the bank's managing director and head, affluent, private bank and branch network, Nitin Chengappa.

Document ABPTEL0020230919ej9j0008i

Standard Chartered launches fifth **private banking** centre in India

Priyanka Boghani

275 words

18 September 2023

Citywire Asia

CWIRAS

English

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Standard Chartered has officially inaugurated its fifth **private banking** centre in Chennai.

The new **private banking** centre, which was first [reported](#) by Citywire Asia in April, aims to serve high-net-worth and ultra-high-net-worth clients through its product and advisory suite.

'Being one of the oldest global banks in India, we have relationships across multi-generations and therefore we can focus both on a traditional approach while offering bespoke, objective, and holistic advice supported by an open architecture platform,' said Standard Chartered's affluent, **private bank** and branch network head, Nitin Chengappa, in a statement from the bank.

'We are excited to open our new **private banking** centre in Chennai. Tamil Nadu is a major economic and financial centre, and we see a lot of potential for growth in our **private banking** business in this region,' he said.

The London-headquartered bank had **private banking** centres in Chennai and Kolkata previously, but due to an internal restructuring it had scaled down to three centres.

The **private bank** is currently in the Indian cities of Mumbai, Delhi, Bengaluru and Kolkata.

Standard Chartered's **private bank** in India, which has \$12bn in assets under management, is focusing on expanding locally across cities in the country. With a large retail piece, the bank is [focusing](#) on the \$5m to \$10m client, its head of India **private banking**, Pankaj Walia, told Citywire Asia earlier this year.

Standard Chartered **Private Bank** currently has a stable of 30 **private bankers** in India. The lender added 10 senior **private bankers** in 2022 from six different organisations, including four internal hires.

Document CWIRAS0020230918ej9i00006



Business

Standard Chartered opens private banking centre in Chennai

FE Bureau

373 words

16 September 2023

Financial Express

AIWFIE

English

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Standard Chartered Bank on Friday opened its private banking centre in Chennai- the fifth private banking centre of the bank after Bengaluru, Delhi, Kolkata and Mumbai. The private banking service is designed for high net worth and ultra high net worth (UHNW) clients offering products, advisory and insights to manage, grow, and protect wealth.

Additionally, the bank's private banking clients get access to a suite of unique investment, wealth and banking solutions. It also supports them with a team of a private banker, service manager, and an investment specialist with access to a full spectrum of solutions for every stage of their business and personal wealth growth.

Also ReadAdapting to hybrid work model: How co-working spaces are changing the workplace of the future

Nitin Chengappa, MD and head, affluent, private bank and branch network, Standard Chartered Bank, India, said, "Being one of the oldest global banks in India, we have relationships across multi-generations and therefore we can focus both on a traditional approach while offering bespoke, objective and holistic advice supported by open architecture platform. We are excited to open our new private banking centre in Chennai. Tamil Nadu is a major economic and financial centre, and we see a lot of potential for growth in our private banking business in this region."

Standard Chartered Bank has been operating in India with a presence of over 160 years making it one of the oldest foreign banks in the country. The bank has a network of 100 branches across 42 cities.

Also ReadIndian steel industry growth story: Building, construction, infrastructure sectors to boost consumption

Pankaj Walia, head of private banking, Standard Chartered Bank, India, said, "India's UHNW population is growing rapidly, and there is a huge opportunity in this space. The country's start-up culture, supported by strong GDP growth and new capital, is creating a new group of billionaires. The bank recognises the clients' diverse wealth management needs and hence, brings access to a full spectrum of end-to-end financial solutions, as a global universal bank, for every stage of the clients personal and business journey.

[The bank has a network of 100 branches across 42 cities. \(IE\)](#)

Document AIWFIE0020230916ej9g0000i

India Business

Standard Chartered Bank launches private banking centre in Chennai

Yogesh Kabirdoss

398 words

16 September 2023

The Times of India

TOI

English

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CHENNAI: Standard Chartered Bank launched its private banking centre in Chennai on Friday targeting ultra high net worth (UHNW) customers. It is the fifth centre to be launched by the leading international banking group in India after Bengaluru, Delhi, Mumbai and Kolkata. Apart from India, the bank operates private banking centres in four other countries, including Singapore, Dubai and Hong Kong. The private banking proposition is designed for UHNW clients offering a range of products, advisory and insights to manage and protect personal and business wealth. Additionally, clients get access to a suite of unique investment, wealth and banking solutions. Nitin Chengappa, MD and head (affluent, private bank and branch network), Standard Chartered Bank India, said the entry threshold for private banking is \$1 million. "We wanted the Chennai centre to be the gateway for Tamil Nadu and Kerala.

As per studies, the state is home for 170-180 UHNWs, which is estimated to grow by 65% in the next five years. This number is going to grow to 275-300 in Tamil Nadu, and we are looking at 25% of them banking with us. Bengaluru and Chennai centres should be contributing 25% in the next three to five years in private banking," he told TOI. The bank has been expanding the (private banking) facility to Hyderabad, Ahmedabad, Pune and Chandigarh over the next 12 months, he added. Noting that the USP in private banking is the international banking offering for the UHNW clients, he said private banking is at the top of the bank's pyramid structure. Globally, the group has presence in 53 countries and serving clients in 64 other nations. While the assets under management (AUM) of the private banking vertical is at \$12 billion as of December 2022 in India, the bank has 900 UHNW families as its clients in the country. Pankaj Walia MD & head - private banking, Standard Chartered Bank India, said Mumbai covering the western states such as Maharashtra and Gujarat and Delhi handling the northern states collectively contributes a share 80% of the AUM, followed by Bengaluru and Kolkata. "Among 100 top billionaires in India, 46 billionaires are part of our private banking. Chennai is among the top five cities of billionaires and our focus is bringing them as part of our network."

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HSBC appoints new head of global private banking in Asia Pacific

189 words

15 September 2023

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SeeNews Banking

SEBNK

English

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September 15 (SeeNews) - HSBC Holdings Plc (LON:HSBC) has appointed Lok Yim as regional head of Global **Private Banking** for the Asia Pacific region, the British lender announced on Thursday.

To be based in Hong Kong, Yim will become part of the London-based banking group on a designate basis on November 1 and will formally step into service on January 1, 2024. His appointment is pending regulatory clearance.

After 16 years at Deutsche Bank, Yim will succeed Siew Meng Tan who is due to retire after an almost 40-year career in the banking sector. In HSBC alone, he spent two decades in senior leadership positions, with seven years at the helm of its Global **Private Banking** business in Asia Pacific. During his tenure, HSBC Global **Private Banking** stepped in major growth markets such as mainland China, India, Taiwan and Thailand.

Tan will remain as an advisor to the business until March 31, 2024.

HSBC Global **Private Banking** has USD 151 billion (EUR 140.48bn) of invested assets as of end-June.

(USD 1.0 = EUR 0.930)

Document SEBNK00020230915ej9f00001



Business

Dubai and Hong Kong establish corridor to promote family offices, fintech and green finance

Enoch Yiu

656 words

14 September 2023

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SCMCOM

English

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* Dubai signs agreement with Hong Kong government, Standard Chartered to promote cross border financial activities, family offices

* Hong Kong virtual insurer OneDegree also has plan to expand in Dubai

The governments of Dubai and Hong Kong have signed an agreement to establish an economic corridor for promoting cross border trading, family offices, fintech and green finance, according to a statement from the Middle East government on Thursday.

Dubai's Department of Economy and Tourism (DET) and Hong Kong's Financial Services and the Treasury Bureau signed the Memorandum of Understanding (MOU) at the two-day Belt and Road Summit which was held in Hong Kong on Wednesday and Thursday.

"This landmark agreement MOU is aligned with the financial services priorities of both cities' governments," said Hadi Badri, CEO of Dubai Economic Development Corporation, part of DET.

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He described the MOU was for "building an economic corridor in partnership with Hong Kong, China to generate incremental and sustainable economic growth."

"I am confident that this MOU will provide a platform for greater economic collaboration between stakeholders participating in the family office and financial services industries in both cities," Badri said.

In March, Hong Kong's government unveiled measures to attract the global ultra rich to set up family offices – corporations set up to pursue investment, philanthropy and succession planning for wealthy families – in the city.

A refreshed investment migration programme, tax breaks and art storage facilities are part of the moves made to achieve Chief Executive John Lee Ka-chiu's target of attracting 200 new family offices by 2025.

A Hong Kong government spokesperson said the MOU will facilitate policy communication between the two cities to explore development in family offices, fintech, virtual asset, green and sustainable finance.

The MOU also adds impetus to Dubai's Economic Agenda 2033 to consolidate the city's status as one of the top three global cities and to double the city's economy in the next decade, the Dubai statement said.

Separately, DET and Standard Chartered Bank Hong Kong office also signed a cooperation agreement on Thursday to develop family offices, wealth management, green finance as well as for providing funding for start-ups.

"As a leading international bank with deep roots in both Hong Kong and Dubai, Standard Chartered is well positioned to help our clients capitalise on the huge opportunities not only in these two markets, but also the bigger markets in Mainland China and the Middle East," said Mary Huen Wai-yi, CEO of Standard Chartered Bank Hong Kong.

She said the bank's income arising from businesses between the markets of China, Africa and Middle East rose 76 per cent in the first half of this year.

DET's Badri said the agreement will help Standard Chartered Bank's Asian clients gain access to the Middle East and Africa via Dubai.

Officials from Hong Kong based virtual insurer OneDegree, will be in Dubai next week to meet with the digital assets industry players and the Virtual Assets Regulatory Authority to talk about the insurance cover it can offer the virtual asset industry.

"There is huge opportunity for OneDegree in the Middle East," Alvin Kwock Yin-lun, OneDegree's co-founder, told the Post on Thursday. "OneDegree started digital asset insurance two years ago. Today, we are the first and only direct insurer in Asia, offering protection to virtual asset service providers and cryptocurrency custodians."

"Supporting the increased collaboration between Hong Kong and UAE, we are bringing our solutions on digital assets insurance and cybersecurity technology to the UAE. We are already in active discussions with the UAE corporations."

Document SCMCOM0020230914ej9e000e0

Julius Baer hires former StanChart China market head

Cheryl Heng

148 words

14 September 2023

Citywire Asia

CWIRAS

English

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Julius Baer has appointed former Standard Chartered **Private Bank** market head Jack Wu as its group head for Greater China.

Wu's role is effective immediately and will be based in Hong Kong, according to a statement from the bank. He joins with over three decades of banking experience, including 23 years focusing on **private banking** in the Greater China region.

Prior to this, Wu had been at Standard Chartered **Private Bank** for six years, latterly as market head for the China market.

He also previously held senior positions at HSBC **Private Bank** and Credit Suisse, where he focused on serving Greater China clients.

The senior hire strengthens Julius Baer's Greater China franchise and demonstrates the bank's commitment to invest in talent to fuel growth, said David Shick, Greater China head and Hong Kong branch manager.

Document CWIRAS0020230914ej9e00003

THE STRAITS TIMES

Straits Times Breaking News

Business

DBS CEO says wealth management business benefiting from inflows

179 words

14 September 2023

The Straits Times

STIMES

English

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HONG KONG - DBS Group's wealth management business has benefited from inflows from across Asia, the Middle East and European regions recently, chief executive Piyush Gupta said on Thursday.

Mr Gupta, speaking at a Reuters Newsmaker event in Singapore, added that the bank expected net inflows to be 'pretty strong' going forward.

He said wealth management was one of the best performing segments in the financial services sector and that the industry could support a high number of participants. His comments come in the wake of UBS Group's emergency takeover of rival Credit Suisse.

Singapore has seen strong inflows from wealthy customers amid global uncertainty, including US-China geopolitical tensions, due to the city-state's status as a financial safe-haven.

The inflows and higher interest rates globally have boosted earnings for Singapore banks. DBS, South-east Asia's largest bank by assets, has predicted a record year for 2023 after posting a forecast-beating 48 per cent jump in second-quarter profit to \$2.69 billion. REUTERS

Document STIMES0020230914ej9e0020b

HSBC's Billimoria: Private banking in UAE is seeing a boom

Paromita Dey

787 words

13 September 2023

Citywire Middle East

CWIRME

English

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Farzad Billimoria, managing director and head of HSBC Private Bank, is bullish on the UAE story and expects other Gulf Cooperation Council (GCC) neighbours to emulate the success.

The UAE has made the most of a strategic geographical location to become a financial gateway between the East and West, and thus turned into a prime location for wealthy individuals looking to access the world's major financial centres.

Billimoria, who has more than 25 years of private banking experience, tells Citywire Middle East: 'The UAE is a renowned luxury hub with world-class real estate, shopping malls and restaurants, excellent international schools, premium healthcare, and a whole host of leisure activities, making it an ideal location for high-net-worth and ultra-high-net worth clients.'

Private banking and associated financial services are consequently in strong demand.'

Three tips for young private bankers:

Belong in your job

Put clients first

Educate yourself

Sector-wise, the private banker is keeping his hopes up for real estate, hospitality, and tourism. 'The UAE has proved to be one of the world's most attractive jurisdictions for real estate investment, with individuals building significant property portfolios and wealth.'

Hospitality and tourism remain buoyant and have seen vigorous expansion, providing a significant contribution to the growth of this country. The growth of hotel accommodation further stimulates tourism to this market and allows neighbouring states to benefit from the influx.'

From a financial market perspective, Billimoria added that income-generating investments are popular given the elevated interest rate environment. Higher yielding quality bonds, whereby clients lock in elevated returns from a fixed income asset class, will continue to be a theme with clients over the near term.

He's also seen a continued growth in the interest in sustainable investing. 'We see this area as one of the fastest-growing segments in the investment world. We continue to partner with our clients on their personal investments as well as their businesses to provide optimal solutions and strategy long term.'

What clients want

According to Billimoria, today's clients demand banks to help them create, manage and pass wealth from one generation to the next.

'We have been able to support our clients in doing this effectively in the UAE, working closely with our colleagues in HSBC's commercial bank and our investment bank,' he says.

The banker has also witnessed several family offices – single- or multi-family setups – establishing their presence in the UAE. Private banking businesses are setting up special desks to cater to these entities, which require a more evolved service compared to an individual customer.

Banks are also supporting the rollout of the UAE government's recent golden visa scheme, which enables investors, entrepreneurs, and other groups to establish long term residency.

This is done via several options – one by placing a deposit with UAE-based banks, which complements the country's strength in key sectors such as financial services, oil and gas, real estate, travel, hospitality, technology, and healthcare.

But there are concerns that every **private banking** client seems to have these days.

'High inflation and interest rates impact operating company margins and business operations, along with geopolitical instability – which impacts global trade flows,' says Billimoria.

Continued volatility from publicly traded securities combined with a lack of client appetite to invest in longer-term illiquid assets has impacted clients' abilities to invest in riskier asset class types.'

What the future holds

2022 was a pivotal year for HSBC Bank Middle East and the **private banking** business as it launched the UAE onshore **private banking** platform for clients with investable assets of more than \$2m.

'Our onshore operations complement the international **private bank** services we have offered in the DIFC since 2014 and ADGM since 2020. The UAE onshore operation brings the number of international wealth centres in the HSBC network to 11, ranking it alongside Switzerland, Singapore, the UK, Luxembourg, Guernsey, Hong Kong, and the US.'

Four tips for young investors:

Start investing early

Mortgage is your friend

Compound wealth early

Diversify

HSBC continues to explore and launch new products across the investment range. The banker reiterates his focus on ensuring that clients have access to a broad range of investment types and look for best-in-class products and funds rather than on the overall number of funds offered.

'We're adapting to the increasingly varied requirements of our clients as well as local and international regulators to secure our position as the leading international **private bank** in the UAE, the wider Middle East, and beyond,' he says.

Farzad's favourites

Favourite book: The Intelligent Investor by Benjamin Graham

Favourite movie: Top Gun

Favourite sport: Squash

Document CWIRME0020230913ej9d00001

HSBC hires five Credit Suisse private bankers for new UK team

Margaryta Kirakosian

195 words

12 September 2023

Citywire

CWIRE

English

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HSBC **Private Banking** has hired five relationship managers from Credit Suisse, covering both high-net-worth and ultra-high-net-worth client segments in the UK.

Phil Aleppo will lead the team, reporting to Charles Boulton, CEO **private banking** UK. At Credit Suisse, Aleppo managed a team of bankers in the UK domestic team.

His newly created group will focus on the senior finance professionals market, including private equity and hedge funds. He will be joined by Henri Etchegoyen, Brad Werner, Usmaan Aziz and Oliver Beasant.

HSBC had \$39bn (£31.3bn) of UK client assets in 2022. So far this year, 30 new relationship managers have joined the bank.

It has also been on a hiring drive in the EMEA region and in June [brought in](#) former UBS and Credit Suisse bankers for its Italian, Swiss, Nordic and Saudi Arabia markets.

HSBC's CEO of UK **private banking** Charles Boulton said: 'These new hires demonstrate our commitment to growth in the UK.'

'Our strong balance sheet combined with our extensive investment proposition and global footprint make us an attractive advisor to sophisticated financial markets clients.'

Document CWIRE00020230912ej9c000jj

StanChart hires global head of wealth planning from JP Morgan

James Phillipps

259 words

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Citywire Middle East

CWIRME

English

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Standard Chartered Bank has recruited Mike Tan from JP Morgan as its new global head of wealth planning and family advisory.

Tan will lead financial planning and family office services for the bank's ultra-high-net-worth clients across its four wealth advisory hubs of Hong Kong, UAE, Jersey and Singapore – where he will be based.

A 20-year industry veteran, he was most recently a member of JP Morgan's wealth advisory team in the city-state and has also previously worked in Hong Kong.

Tan will report into SCB global head of private and affluent banking Raymond Ang.

On the appointment, Ang said: 'Wealth planning and family advisory is an integral part of our proposition as a trusted advisor for our clients and it enhances our offering to serve the banking and wealth needs of ultra-high-net-worth individuals, families and family offices across our network.'

Standard Chartered **Private Bank** last week [reshuffled its Southeast Asia teams](#) following the departures of Andrew Ho and Lawrence Goh, the bank's Southeast Asia market head and deputy market head Asean, respectively.

Singapore-based Vijai Krovvidi, who holds the title of market head, Singapore, Malaysia and Global South Asia, has taken on an expanded role, absorbing Ho and Goh's teams.

The British lender also [hired Peter Tung](#) as regional head of **private banking** for Greater China and North Asia earlier this year. He replaced Vivian Chan, who was promoted to global vice chairman of **private banking** last October.

Document CWIRME0020230912ej9c00004

HSBC Global Private Banking and Wealth Q4 2023 Outlook: Seeking the less usual suspects

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720 words

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Contify Banking News

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English

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HSBC Global Private Banking and Wealth identifies opportunities against a backdrop of plateauing rates and a broadly supportive growth-inflation mix for markets. A tenet of its portfolio strategy is to broaden the opportunity set to the less usual suspects, to help clients navigate the concentrated outperformance seen in specific equity sectors and country allocations.

Original Press Release:

Sept. 8 -- HSBC Holdings Holdings issued the following news release:

- Largest overweight positions are high quality medium-duration credit and US Treasuries, supported by peak Fed rates
- Equities require a broadened opportunity set — beyond US mega caps and largest economies — due to valuations and a multi-speed economy

In its latest quarterly investment outlook, HSBC Global Private Banking and Wealth identifies opportunities against a backdrop of plateauing rates and a broadly supportive growth-inflation mix for markets. A tenet of its Q4 2023 portfolio strategy is to broaden the opportunity set to the less usual suspects, to help clients navigate the concentrated outperformance seen in specific equity sectors and country allocations.

The global private bank has four investment priorities for the fourth quarter:

- * Lock in bond yields of medium duration quality credit
- * Broaden the opportunity set in equities
- * Position for the structural shift towards sustainability
- * Manage risks through uncorrelated assets and volatility strategies
- * Rate hikes: an end in sight

HSBC Global Private Banking and Wealth believes the Federal Reserve has finished hiking rates, and that the European Central Bank and Bank of England will soon follow suit. The end of the Fed's hiking cycle provides supportive conditions for bond markets, and therefore HSBC Global Private Banking and Wealth keeps high quality medium-duration credit and US Treasuries as its largest overweight positions.

Equity opportunities: unusual suspects

The environment of peak rates has also been a significant support for growth stocks, particularly the technology mega caps in the US. As the US economy remains resilient, HSBC Global Private Banking and Wealth believes this sets the scene for a broadened equity rally beyond those 'usual suspects'. While maintaining an overweight on US technology, it sees additional opportunities in US industrials, financials, consumer discretionary and healthcare.

This view applies to country allocations as well, with the team taking a positive stance on stocks in India, Indonesia, Mexico and Brazil – beyond its overweight on the US. The cyclical outlook is supportive in India and Indonesia, which benefit from supply chain diversification, as well as the rapid digitalisation of India's economy.

Thematically, HSBC Global **Private Banking** and Wealth has added two new US themes to its existing consumer-focused American Resilience theme, specifically: US Industrial Resurgence and Innovation & Opportunities in US Healthcare. These additions demonstrate the global **private bank**'s broad optimism on US stocks and its willingness to look beyond the usual suspects.

Positioning for the structural shift towards sustainability

Significant investments in the net zero transition are a positive across the Asia region as well, speaking to the ongoing investment priority of positioning for economic shifts towards long-term sustainability. High conviction themes include energy transition and independence, investing in biodiversity and Asia's green transformation.

Navigating volatility

To complete its approach, HSBC Global **Private Banking** and Wealth adds hedge funds and volatility strategies, to take advantage of dispersion and to temper any volatility from temporary regime shifts.

Willem Sels, Global Chief Investment Officer at HSBC Global **Private Banking** and Wealth added: "After the Fed stops hiking, both bonds and equities tend to do well. So we continue to advocate that people invest their cash. But we really emphasise quality, both in terms of bond ratings and quality earnings, and clear differentiation on that basis. Thematically, we continue to strongly believe in the structural growth in Asia, the digital economy and the sustainability revolution. These trends intersect and reinforce each other, which is why we continue to look for the best ways to invest in them."

HSBC Holdings plc

HSBC Holdings plc, the parent company of HSBC, is headquartered in London. HSBC serves customers worldwide from offices in 62 countries and territories. With assets of USD3,041 billion at 30 June 2023, HSBC is one of the world's largest banking and financial services organisations.

Source: HSBC Holdings

[Category: Banks, Banks, Retail/ Commercial Bank, Events]

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Standard Chartered **Private Bank** reshuffles Southeast Asia team

Priyanka Boghani

205 words

7 September 2023

Citywire Asia

CWIRAS

English

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Standard Chartered **Private Bank** has reshuffled its Southeast Asia teams following two departures, Citywire Asia has learnt.

Vijai Krovvidi has absorbed the teams of Andrew Ho and Lawrence Goh, the bank's Southeast Asia market head and deputy market head Asean, respectively, who have both left the bank.

Singapore-based Krovvidi, who holds the title of market head, Singapore, Malaysia and Global South Asia, will have an expanded role, as he oversees a larger team.

Ho joined the bank in 2016 as a market head for Indonesia, while Goh joined in 2021 as a deputy market head for the Asean region.

Krovvidi joined Standard Chartered more recently, in June 2022, from UBS where he spent more than a decade. He has also worked at Deutsche Bank.

A spokesperson for the bank could not be reached for comment at the time of publishing.

Last month, the bank [hired](#) Vimal Bali to cover the non-resident Indian segment, reporting to Dhruv Sawhney, a team lead at Standard Chartered.

Earlier this year, the British lender [named](#) former DBS head of **private banking** for Greater China Peter Tung as its regional head, **private banking**, Greater China and North Asia.

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Business

UOB on fast track to be Asean's bank of choice with Citi acquisition

Ven Sreenivasan Associate Editor &, UOB on fast track to be Asean's bank of choice with Citi acquisition

1,592 words

5 September 2023

The Straits Times

STIMES

English

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UOB's \$5 billion acquisition of Citigroup's consumer businesses in Malaysia, Thailand, Vietnam and Indonesia will be a game changer by doubling the bank's Asean customer base outside Singapore and accelerating its regional customer base target five years ahead of time.

So says UOB's head of group retail Eddie Khoo, who helped oversee the acquisition.

"In one fell swoop, we have expanded our presence and capabilities in the four key areas of banking -- transactions, savings, investment and protection -- right across the region," he said. "Our ambition has always been to become the preferred bank of choice for Asean. The Citi acquisition now enables us to get there faster."

Mr Khoo said the acquisition would see UOB take Citi's huge credit card franchise and consumer loans business, including its sizeable personal and unsecured lending portfolio.

"We are on track to achieve our projected annualised revenue uplift of around \$1 billion from the four markets for the full year, a figure which would have taken us five years to achieve via pure organic growth."

First announced in January 2022, the deal will see UOB paying a premium of around \$915 million on top of the net asset value of the Citigroup consumer businesses, which stood at \$4 billion as at June 30, 2021.

The acquisition of Citi's consumer franchises in Malaysia and Thailand was completed in November 2022, followed by Vietnam in March 2023. Indonesia's will be completed later in 2023.

The integration process has already started, with Citi's Malaysian consumer business being absorbed in July 2023.

Indonesia will come on stream in November, followed by Thailand in the first quarter of 2024.

Citi's Vietnam business will be assimilated into the UOB universe in late 2024.

In the process, UOB is also absorbing most of Citi's 5,000 staff around the region.

"While some have decided to move on, the vast majority have decided to stay," Mr Khoo said. "The attrition rate is very low."

More than 90 per cent of related Citigroup consumer bank employees in Malaysia and 80 per cent of their counterparts in Thailand, including 100 per cent of the leadership team, have already transferred to UOB.

Helping the integration is the appreciation Citi staff have of UOB's culture of retaining and cultivating talent, Mr Khoo said.

"As our chief executive Wee Ee Cheong puts it, we like to 'grow our own timber'. We identify talent and cultivate them."

He revealed that there were 17 work streams covering areas of products and solutions, people, processes and systems to ensure a seamless integration.

The process has been smoother than anticipated.

"We had team-building exercises in Malaysia, Thailand and Vietnam for all the consumer heads. During the exercise, we found that perceptions and ideas across the two groups were more similar than we had expected."

UOB had guided for \$700 million to \$800 million one-off integration costs in the first two years, mainly due to payments to Citi for the use of the latter's platform during the transition and integration period, tech migration, headcount and rebranding.

Mr Khoo said that the expenditure so far has been within this budget.

"For this year, we will be clocking in around \$300 million to \$400 million in post-tax one-off costs, and these one-off costs should be substantially over by the end of 2023," he said.

The merger will give UOB a leg-up in the cards and unsecured lending business.

Citigroup's portfolio, which is geared more towards the cards business and unsecured lending, saw net credit card fees grow more than 50 per cent during the first half of 2023.

UOB expects total income from the bank's unsecured business to almost double by the end of 2023.

"Citi cards customers, coupled with UOB's already strong cards leadership position, will give us top position in the consumer cards space for Visa and Mastercard portfolios in terms of billings," he said.

During the first quarter of 2023, total cross-border billings for UOB credit cards in Asean grew almost three times compared with the same period last year, Mr Khoo added.

"The Citi acquisition puts us in a stronger position to crystallise strategic partnerships to cater to our customers' growing lifestyle needs. We now have 45 strategic and co-brand partnerships across multiple markets. The Taylor Swift show is one of the results of our strong regional customer franchise and strategic partnerships."

UOB tied up an exclusive pre-sale partnership for the concerts of the American singer, letting its cardholders get priority booking for tickets.

UOB already had a strong presence in Singapore, Malaysia and Thailand even before the Citigroup deal.

Founded in 1935 as United Chinese Bank by businessman Wee Kheng Chiang, it was renamed United Overseas Bank in 1965.

It steadily expanded its footprint across Singapore, Malaysia and Thailand through acquisitive growth of local banking franchises, giving it a branch presence in virtually every city in these countries.

But Mr Khoo stressed that the UOB of today is a very different animal from the UOB of several decades ago.

"We could not have done this acquisition 10 or 15 years ago," he said. "But over the years, we built up our capabilities and hired the right people with the suitable mindset for growth. In the process, we have also built a run team of over 2,000 people who are figuratively changing the tyres while the car is still running."

Mr Khoo himself was one of UOB's key hires almost two decades ago.

Having started his banking career 38 years ago with Citigroup, he spent two years at DBS Bank, before moving to UOB 18 years ago.

He has been instrumental in the roll-out of the award-winning UOB TMRW app, which enables customers to do all their financial transactions from the palm of their hand.

The Citi acquisition has raised the stakes and increased the pace of UOB's transformation, Mr Khoo said.

"We are now looking at over 7.3 million customers spread over five markets in wholesale, retail, bancassurance, **wealth management** and much more."

He said the Citigroup acquisition would enable UOB to realise its ambition to build a formidable pan-Asean footprint and pan-Asian brand.

"In the current era, we are not just competing on quality of services and solutions. The competitive advantage is built also upon experience, in appearance and substance, and also brand association.

"We want to be seen as a progressive Asean brand whom the increasingly affluent middle-income of the region would trust."

While European banks are dominant in the upper echelons of **private banking**, UOB is also taking strides to build its business in this segment.

"While the Citi integration is keeping us busy, we are also working on the entire spectrum of wealth," said Mr Khoo, adding that, despite claims to the contrary, there was no clear winner yet in the Asean wealth space.

"I believe we have the opportunity to build a unique model that people understand. A model which is best in class in Asean."

Mr Khoo said UOB was well positioned to take up the challenge given its No. 1 position in unit trust volume and its significant presence in bancassurance with the Prudential group.

He revealed that UOB's bancassurance, in which banks offer insurance products to its customers, accounted for a third of its wealth franchise.

"We doubled down on building our business for HNWI (high-net-worth individuals) in 2022. We combined our **private bank** and privilege reserve business to create a private wealth group, giving us the scale and resources to accelerate product and solution innovation and roll-out."

From about 200 bankers in 2021, UOB **wealth management** added around 55 more in 2022 and expects to grow its strength of private wealth relationship managers to 300 by the end of 2023.

Total assets under management across UOB's entire wealth business stood at \$165 billion as at end June 2023, of which more than half is attributed to private wealth (that is, privilege reserve and **private bank**).

The bank has also enjoyed 19 per cent growth year on year, mostly from net new money inflows, said Mr Khoo.

"About 60 per cent of our customers are businessmen and entrepreneurs with investible funds of between \$3 million and \$10 million, and the \$4 million to \$5 million is a sweet spot for us," he said.

He reckons the takeover of the Citigroup retail franchise will propel UOB's **private banking** franchise.

One of the key drivers of UOB's wealth franchise is its digital capabilities, Mr Khoo added.

The future of banking has to be progressive and cater to an increasingly digital and tech-savvy clientele, he said.

In the wealth segment, many of these are clients who are taking over their parents' businesses around the region.

"We have to cater to this market and be the best in class, whether **wealth management**, credit card offerings, savings, investments and protection products or any other aspect of banking.

"For UOB, the future of banking is about being a progressive Asean brand, the bank of choice for aspiring Asean individuals."

The Citi acquisition has raised the stakes and increased the pace of UOB's transformation, said UOB's head of group retail Eddie Khoo. ST PHOTO: SHINTARO TAY

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Supplement 1

HSBC bullish on opportunities in Asia as region's wealth creation outpaces peers

, HSBC bullish on opportunities in Asia as region's wealth creation outpaces peers

1,627 words

23 August 2023

Business Times Singapore

STBT

English

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ASIA is on the fast track to become the world's wealth centre. Its allure as the destination for business and investments has made it a magnet for new wealth inflows from within the region and globally.

The International Monetary Fund has upgraded its estimate for 2023 growth in emerging and developing Asia from 4.9 per cent to 5.3 per cent, which is more than triple the expected pace of expansion in the United States and more than seven times that of Europe.

A report by HSBC Global Research sees wealth in Asia excluding Japan outstripping the US by 2025. The number of millionaires in the region is also poised to jump from roughly 30 million to 76 million by 2030.

HSBC has positioned itself to capture the region's growth in wealth, says Lavanya Chari, the bank's Global Head of Investments and Wealth Solutions for its global **private banking** and wealth business. "Asia's acceleration contrasts with slower growth in the West, and we believe it is a great time to invest here."

HSBC has continued to widen its **private banking** presence in the region, launching its services in India in July this year. According to HSBC Global Research, the number of adults in India with a net worth of at least US\$250,000 is expected to reach close to 60 million by 2030, while the number of millionaires is estimated to surpass the 10 million mark.

Chari says India has an attractive growth environment, which is a large factor behind Asia's upturn.

The launch in India demonstrated the bank's commitment to building a leading wealth management business in Asia through its wealth solutions expertise, extensive international network and access to commercial banking, global banking and markets capabilities.

Chari emphasises the other factors leading to Asia's upturn including China's reopening and road to recovery, as well as opportunities in Asean. "Asean used to be a fraction of some larger economies, but now it has overtaken many of them."

In the Asean region, the economies that likely see the highest GDP growth in 2024 are Vietnam (6.7 per cent), the Philippines (5.6 per cent), Indonesia (5 per cent), Thailand (4.1 per cent), Malaysia (4.7 per cent) and Singapore (2.7 per cent), according to HSBC Global Research.

"With the strong fundamental growth in the domestic economy across Indonesia, Malaysia and Vietnam, and Singapore being a hub for finance, wealth and asset management, the opportunity set is very compelling," says Jeffrey Yap, South-East Asia Head of Investments and Wealth Solutions for HSBC's global **private banking** business.

Chari echoes this: "We are bullish on the Asean opportunity."

Singapore, in particular, has been growing in prominence as a wealth hub. The team considers the country to be a "linchpin" hub connecting international and regional onshore markets.

Yap says the country's hub serves as a "corridor" for investment flows from Asean, North Asia and the Middle East.

"Singapore is among the fastest growing international wealth centres. It's up there with Hong Kong and Switzerland," he adds.

Elevating client experience

As banks' digital capabilities grow, they are increasingly leveraging new technologies to attract more clients and better serve the needs of their existing clients. Demand for advice-based relationships has also been rising in Asia as the macroeconomic environment becomes more complex.

HSBC Global **Private Banking** is committed to enhancing the experience for its clients and is investing significantly to transform its digital capabilities. In Asia, it has invested more than US\$100 million in its core **private banking** and digital platforms from 2021 to 2022. This investment is having a significant impact in how clients are interacting with HSBC.

Currently, two-thirds of HSBC **private bank**'s clients are digitally engaged. The improvements the bank is making is increasingly being recognised within the industry with the bank winning several awards recently, including for Customer Facing Digital Capabilities (South-East Asia) in the WealthBriefingAsia Awards 2023.

Whilst clients welcome the digital improvements the bank is making, the ability to engage directly with HSBC's relationship managers and investment counsellors remains a key priority for clients.

"Clients like to have sophisticated portfolios and risk analytics combined with a human touch when it matters," says Chari.

An example of how the bank combines sophisticated analysis with the human touch, is the bank's Prism Advisory service - introduced in Hong Kong and Singapore in November 2022. This is a hybrid service using institutional-level portfolio analytics powered by Aladdin Wealth technology, an industry-leading investment and risk platform from BlackRock, combined with the human expertise of HSBC's investment advisers.

Since its launch, Prism Advisory has seen significant interest from clients, says Chari, with clients attracted by its more sophisticated and data-led approach and wide range of features. For example, HSBC investment advisers can now access over 3,000 risk factors monitored by Aladdin, allowing them to measure the level of risk in a client's portfolio daily.

Overall, the work the bank has done to enhance its digital propositions and technology has allowed HSBC's relationship managers to spend less time on administrative tasks and focus on serving clients better, says Chari. Whilst an increasingly data-driven service helps the bank to accurately pinpoint the best solutions for customers, Chari says that high net worth individuals (HNWIs) still care deeply about human relationships.

"This does not imply we don't need digital enhancements. We absolutely need to make these improvements to meet the evolving needs of our clients - just not at the expense of that critical human touch," concludes Chari.

Catering to clients' needs

Offering tailored solutions enables HSBC to act on key trends that interest HNWIs, who are looking for long-term and wide-ranging solutions.

Such trends include alternatives such as hedge funds, private equity, real estate and infrastructure debt.

Yap says alternative assets were once made almost exclusively to institutional investors; but **private banking** clients have started accessing such alternative assets in the last five years or so.

"We aim to serve our clients in a holistic manner," Chari says, adding that clients should look across various asset classes to create a diversified portfolio.

HSBC has over the past year worked to improve the range of investment opportunities and channels available to different clientele types. For example, the range of products and services that is available for family offices has since been expanded to cater for their specific needs.

Safeguarding clients' futures

HSBC is also the leading adviser to South-east Asia's ultra-rich families with more than 75 years of experience in wealth planning across generations and geographies through its trust business in Singapore.

Succession planning is not a new space. Following the Covid-19 pandemic, however, client perceptions have changed. Succession planning is less of a taboo topic, and the bank now sees more clients in Asia becoming comfortable addressing this traditionally difficult topic.

HSBC Global **Private Banking**'s trust administration offering has been a core aspect of helping families protect their wealth, says Chari.

"Given the nature of this business, and the trust the clients have placed in us, we support them from a very early stage with investment matters, liquidity investments, insurance protection and philanthropic ambitions."

Through these areas, HSBC's wealth planners and trust relationship managers are able to advise clients through different life stages, from day-to-day living to unique life events, with succession planning being a key part of their work.

Yap says: "When we discuss with clients around investments, and environment, social and governance (ESG), there is also a conversation about legacy planning and wealth being passed on. This is where our trust administrative services come into the discussion to provide a long-term solution for our clients."

Supporting a green future

HSBC Global **Private Banking** has also made strides to reach the bank's aim of reducing emissions, in line with a 1.5-degree pathway.

Chari says ESG is a topic close to her heart and she works closely with her team to support clients throughout their ESG journeys.

Clients are interested in ESG but do not want to invest in it blindly. "They want to be educated in ESG, in order to understand how they can invest and what the impacts might be," says Chari. The bank emphasises thought leadership to help its clients to learn about this area.

At HSBC Global **Private Banking**, adopting an ESG-enhanced approach helps clients invest in companies with bigger ESG investment intentions. The bank also offers thematic products in this area, enabling sustainable investing via themes such as renewables, water conservation and the circular economy. The bank's impact solutions allow clients to deliver change as part of an intended investment outcome.

The mix of approaches has given clients different ways to view their portfolios and identify which areas they do not want to be exposed to, based on their own sustainability goals and financial objectives.

Yap says it is important that the client-facing team is equipped to discuss ESG with clients, as some clients may not know where to begin. The team may use a questionnaire to work out what customers' ESG preferences are, which can then be used to tailor specific solutions.

Chari believes that HSBC's clients benefit from the bank's position as a "strong, universal bank" with a wide range of wealth products to choose from when building diverse portfolios.

"We are a global bank and our ability to offer international solutions is a significant advantage for our clients," she says.

Document STBT000020230822ej8n002eo

Malaysia's **private bankers** are few and far between

Citywire Asia Staff

464 words

22 August 2023

Citywire Asia

CWIRAS

English

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Finding a quality **private banker** is a perennial problem in many of Asia's onshore markets, as wealth creation is at a nascent stage compared with centres like Hong Kong and Singapore, according to a Malaysia-based **private banking** head.

'Hiring good quality relationship managers has been a key challenge for many financial institutions looking to provide good support and advice to clients especially on complex matters and on how to make their investment portfolio more holistic and robust,' said Joey Pang, OCBC Bank (Malaysia) Berhad's head of wealth investment.

OCBC Bank (Malaysia) **opened** its wealth business in Malaysia through its **private banking** arm, Bank of Singapore, in June 2022.

A key challenge is retaining talent. The market is seeing a great rotation of assets under management from one **private bank** to another as relationship managers with sizeable client bases and assets under management are preferred, said Edwin Leong, head of product innovations and research at RHB Group Asset Management (Malaysia and Singapore).

As a result, **private banks** will need to look for ways to incentivise relationship managers, particularly as different career opportunities have opened for fresh graduates.

'The industry is facing stiff competition from 'new' opportunities such as being a social media influencer, online marketing, ride-hailing and many other jobs that may be able to generate as good or better income for the younger generation,' said Leong.

Indeed, the bank's reputation, the attractiveness of its compensation package as well as the quality of its platform and technology for supporting bankers, rank among the top considerations for prospective employees.

Building on existing skills

More foreign and local wealth managers are bound to set up shop in Malaysia, deepening the talent pool in the country, but until then, one option open to **private banks** is to upskill existing talent.

'Many banks, including OCBC Bank, have over the years been building talent organically. We have a programme for the development of young talent where the bank provides broad-based banking knowledge and on-the-job rotation guided by a mentor with opportunities to work on business innovation projects,' Pang said.

Malaysia has become an attractive Asean onshore proposition for **private banks**. The country is slated to see a 43% increase in the number of ultra-high-net-worth individuals between 2021 and 2026, according to a Knight Frank Wealth Report last year.

As clients expect more comprehensive product and advisory offerings, **private bankers** will need to demonstrate a thirst for learning about new assets, markets, concepts and structures, Pang said.

He added that finding 'candidates who can demonstrate leadership, have a penchant for problem-solving and are able to embrace new challenges,' while matching the requirements of the bankers, is key.

Document CWIRAS0020230822ej8m0002t



Business

DBS bets big on China's record wealth piled after GBA investors spooked by dismal run of property and stocks

Mia Castagnone

866 words

18 August 2023

scmp.com

SCMCOM

English

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* DBS opens strategically located new outlet in Central to focus on customers coming from mainland China

* China's savings have struck a historical peak after the property sector crash and a stock market underperformance soured investor's risk appetite

DBS Bank is bulking up its presence in the Greater Bay Area to tap China's wealthy who are sitting on hoards of cash after their traditional investment areas – property and stocks – turned in dismal performances.

The opening of a strategically located new outlet in Central will add to the Singapore lender's network of conveniently placed branches in Tsim Sha Tsui, Causeway Bay and Central, to focus on customers coming from mainland China.

The new shop will be the flagship store of DBS Treasures, the **wealth management** arm of the business, and will service both mainland and local customers as well as the Treasures' Private Client and Private Bank customers.

Do you have questions about the biggest topics and trends from around the world? Get the answers with [SCMP Knowledge](#), our new platform of curated content with explainers, FAQs, analyses and infographics brought to you by our award-winning team.

"DBS China is working very hard to offer **wealth management** capabilities to those customers in mainland China. With the border open, there's a tremendous flow of affluent potential customers coming to Hong Kong," said Sebastian Paredes, CEO of DBS Bank Hong Kong. "We are expanding our offshore teams to service them."

China's volatile markets have made investors wary and there is a pent-up demand for **wealth management** products, according to Paredes.

"Wealth in the past had been directed to the real estate sector and to domestic capital markets and in the last year or so, even more of the real estate sector in China has undergone serious challenges and the capital markets has been quite muted," said Paredes.

In the year to date, the MSCI China Index has tumbled 7 per cent, underperforming the MSCI Asia ex-Japan benchmark which is down 1 per cent and the yuan currency struck a 9-month low this week as foreign investors hit the exits. China's property investment extended its fall for the 17th consecutive month in July as the sector was blighted by plunging sales, tight liquidity and a series of developer defaults since late 2021.

Importantly, there is substantial savings accumulated in China searching for alternative investments, preferably offshore, he added.

This has led to the historically high wealth pile in China. [Chinese residents' savings grew by 12 trillion yuan](#) in the first half of this year – or 67 per cent of the full-year growth in 2022, according to a recent report.

Customers have crossed the border to Hong Kong in their hunt for new investment products as their diversification needs soared.

"We're doubling up on our investments to service these mainland Chinese customers with **wealth management** and insurance products," said Paredes. In addition, the bank is growing its private banking sector to cater to Chinese customers.

The asset and **wealth management** business in Hong Kong amounted to over HK\$30.5 trillion (US\$3.9 trillion) as of the end of 2022, with 64 per cent of the flows originating from non-Hong Kong investors, according to Hong Kong's Financial Services and the Treasury Bureau.

DBS Hong Kong hosted a "Greater Bay Area Conference" in Shenzhen last week- its first in person conference since the pandemic began. The conference focused on the GBA's economic transformation and sought to help customers seize new opportunities in an environment of change.

It attracted regional business leaders, including the former head of the Hong Kong stock exchange, [Charles Li Xiaojia](#), who spoke about the benefits of technology to enhance mobility in the GBA.

"DBS Group believes that the GBA will bring substantial investment opportunities, with unlimited growth potential, to Hong Kong and Asia," said Paredes.

Paredes added that the key to attracting mainland customers was offering high quality services and building trust with customers. The [collapse of regional banks in the US](#) earlier this year in an environment of soaring interest rates, has caused customers to be more cautious around the banks they choose to work with.

A good credit rating and operating within Hong Kong and Singapore's highly regulated banking environment, has made a difference when attracting Chinese investors. The group is rated AA- by Fitch, three notches below the highest AAA rating.

"[Chinese customers] see DBS as a bank committed to Asia, a bank that has a very long term view, that is committed to China and servicing Chinese customers," said Paredes, adding that DBS financial track record also spurred consumer confidence. The bank reported a return on equity of 19.2 per cent in the last quarter, an all time high.

Even as investors have turned increasingly negative on Chinese stocks, DBS remains positive on the overall equity market outlook. The bank was ranked third on the regional ECM league table in the first half of the year, the highest since 2010, according to Bloomberg data.

Document SCMCOM0020230818ej8i0002u



Business

DBS taps China's wealth pile with outlet in Central

Mia Castagnone

643 words

18 August 2023

South China Morning Post

SCMP

B1

English

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The new shop will be the flagship store of DBS Treasures, the bank's **wealth management** arm, and will service both mainland and local customers, as well as Treasures' private client and private bank customers.

"DBS China is working very hard to offer **wealth management** capabilities to those customers in mainland China. With the border open, there's a tremendous flow of affluent potential customers coming to Hong Kong," said Sebastian Paredes, CEO of DBS Bank (Hong Kong). "We are expanding our offshore teams to service them."

China's volatile markets had made investors wary and there was pent-up demand for **wealth management** products, Paredes said.

"Wealth in the past had been directed to the real estate sector and domestic capital markets, and in the last year or so, even more of the real estate sector in China has undergone serious challenges and the capital markets have been quite muted," Paredes said.

In the year to date, the MSCI China Index has lost 7 per cent, underperforming the MSCI Asia ex-Japan benchmark, which is down by 1 per cent, and the yuan struck a nine-month low this week as foreign investors hit the exits.

The country's property investment also extended its fall for the 17th consecutive month in July as the sector was blighted by plunging sales, tight liquidity and a series of developer defaults since late 2021.

Importantly, there was substantial savings accumulated in China searching for alternative investments, preferably offshore, Paredes said.

This has led to the historic- high wealth pile in China. Mainland residents' savings grew by 12 trillion yuan (HK\$12.8 trillion) in the first half of this year, or 67 per cent of the full-year growth in 2022, according to a recent report.

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The event attracted regional business leaders, including the former head of the Hong Kong exchange, Charles Li Xiaojia, who spoke about the benefits of technology to enhance mobility in the bay area.

"DBS Group believes the [bay area] will bring substantial investment opportunities with unlimited growth potential to Hong Kong and Asia," Paredes said.

He added the key to attracting mainland customers was offering high-quality services and building trust with them.

The collapse of regional banks in the United States earlier this year amid soaring interest rates has caused customers to be more cautious about the banks they choose to work with.

Even as investors have turned negative on mainland stocks, DBS remains positive on the overall equity market outlook.

mia.castagnone@scmp.com

Document SCMP000020230817ej8i00010

Exclusive: Ex-StanChart senior RM rejoins HSBC GPB in Singapore

Cheryl Heng

179 words

16 August 2023

Citywire Asia

CWIRAS

English

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A former Standard Chartered senior relationship manager has joined HSBC Global **Private Banking**, responsible for global India, Citywire Asia can confirm.

Hemant Geriani has rejoined HSBC GPB as an RM, reporting to Manoj Ramarao, managing director – head of global India business.

A spokesperson for the bank confirmed the hire.

Geriani was with Standard Chartered for five years. Prior to that, he was with DBS for another five years, first as a relationship manager for its Treasures tier in Singapore, then as a **private banker** in Dubai.

He has also had a stint with HSBC GPB in Bangalore. Gerinani also held positions as a credit manager at Citibank in India and as corporate banking relationship manager at HDFC Bank.

HSBC GPB [recently named UBS GWM's former family office co-head Tommy Leung as its South Asia head](#). Leung will be taking over from 19 October, following the departure of Philip Kunz.

South Asia includes India, where the **private bank** [recently opened its doors after an eight-year gap](#).

Document CWIRAS0020230817ej8g00004



HSBC launches wealth advisory services in Kuwait

163 words

15 August 2023

13:04

SeeNews Banking

SEBNK

English

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August 15 (SeeNews) - British lender HSBC Holdings Plc said on Monday it has appointed a new head for its **private banking** operations in Kuwait as it plans to start offering onshore wealth management advisory services in the Asian country.

The bank has appointed Rayan Kazerooni to lead Global **Private Banking** for HSBC Kuwait. He will join the British group's unit in Kuwait from the Dubai branch of Bank of London and the Middle East plc.

In his new role, Kazerooni will work closely with HSBC's Global **Private Banking** centres in the UAE, Switzerland, the UK and Singapore. He will be responsible for the Kuwaiti unit's offerings to wealthy families, entrepreneurs and business owners.

HSBC has been recently working to expand its wealth management business on a global scale, with a focus on Asian markets. During the past 12 months, the strategy resulted in the launch of new activities in the UAE, India and Mexico.

Document SEBNK00020230815ej8f00001

HSBC Appoints Head of Global **Private Banking** in Kuwait, Launching Onshore Advisory Services

Distributed by Contify.com

540 words

14 August 2023

Contify Banking News

ATINBK

English

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HSBC launches onshore **wealth management** advisory services in Kuwait. Rayan Kazerooni has been appointed Head of Global **Private Banking** for HSBC Kuwait.

Key Highlights:

- * Kazerooni will work closely with HSBCs established Global **Private Banking** centres in the UAE, Switzerland, the United Kingdom, and Singapore.
- * HSBC Global **Private Banking** has expanded coverage in key markets, including the UAE, India, and Mexico.
- * Samer Alabed, CEO of HSBC Kuwait, stated that providing clients with investment advice and tailored solutions is an important development for HSBC in Kuwait.

Original Press Release:

KUWAIT, Aug. 14 -- HSBC issued the following news release:

HSBC has launched onshore **wealth management** advisory services in Kuwait, expanding HSBC's Global **Private Bank** offering in the country as part of HSBC's commitment to provide investment and **wealth management** solutions to support clients to achieve their ambitions. Rayan Kazerooni has been appointed Head of Global **Private Banking** for HSBC Kuwait, joining HSBC from the Dubai branch of Bank of London and the Middle East plc, and he will work closely with HSBC's established Global **Private Banking** centres in the UAE, Switzerland, the United Kingdom and Singapore to grow the bank's business in Kuwait. This represents another milestone in the growth of HSBC Global **Private Banking**, which has expanded coverage in key markets – including the launch in the past 12 months of new operations in the UAE, India and Mexico – to enhance the bank's services and support for wealthy individuals, families, and entrepreneurs. Samer Alabed, CEO of HSBC Kuwait said: "HSBC Kuwait is constantly seeking to open up a world of opportunity for our clients. Providing clients with investment advice and tailored solutions that support their wealth ambitions, with seamless connections to our asset management, commercial banking, markets, and personal wealth divisions to provide an impeccable, tailor-made service adapted to the needs of wealthy families, entrepreneurs, and business owners, is an important development for HSBC in Kuwait."

HSBC in the MENAT region

HSBC is the largest and most widely represented international banking organisation in the Middle East, North Africa and Türkiye (MENAT), with a presence in nine countries across the region: Algeria, Bahrain, Egypt, Kuwait, Oman, Qatar, Saudi Arabia, Türkiye and the United Arab Emirates. In Saudi Arabia, HSBC is a 31 per cent shareholder of Saudi Awwal Bank (SAB), and a 51 per cent shareholder of HSBC Saudi Arabia for investment banking in the Kingdom. Across MENAT, HSBC had assets of USD71 billion as at 31 December 2022.

HSBC Global **Private Banking**

HSBC Global **Private Banking** provides banking, investment and **wealth management** solutions for individuals, families, business owners, entrepreneurs and investors. Their ambitions and the decisions they make today can shape the world of tomorrow and we help our clients grow, manage and preserve their wealth, now and across generations.

With our international network and breadth of services, we connect clients to meaningful opportunities worldwide. We provide wealth planning and family governance services, while our experts in philanthropy support clients in their ambition to have a positive impact on society. For more information, visit www.privatebanking.hsbc.com.

Source: HSBC

[Category: Banks, Asset Management/ Mutual Funds, Financial/ Capital Market, New Offerings]

Document ATINBK0020230816ej8e000gv

HSBC hires Kuwait private banking head as it launches onshore advisory services

Margaryta Kirakosian

218 words

14 August 2023

Citywire Middle East

CWIRME

English

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HSBC has hired Rayan Kazerooni as Kuwait's head of global private banking, as it rolls out onshore advisory services in the country.

<figure></figure>

As part of the new role, Kazerooni will work closely with HSBC's global private banking centres in the UAE, Switzerland, the UK and Singapore to grow the onshore business.

Kazerooni recently worked at the Dubai branch of the Bank of London and the BLME group. Before that he held senior roles at Global Investment House, Qatar First Bank and J Safra Sarasin in Dubai.

In the past 12 months, HSBC has launched new operations in the UAE, India and Mexico to expand the bank's offering for wealthy individuals, families and entrepreneurs.

It currently has more than 200 relationship managers across the EMEA region, where the firm manages \$153bn in private banking assets.

The firm has recently been on a hiring drive, recruiting former Credit Suisse and UBS bankers to cover Swiss, Saudi Arabian, Italian and Northern European clients.

Mario Luis Penabad joined as UHNW head while Mathieu Brizon joined as senior relationship manager for Saudi Arabia clients.

The firm is leveraging its established onshore presence in Saudi Arabia through its investment banking joint venture between HSBC and SAB.

Document CWIRME0020230814ej8e00002

THE STRAITS TIMES

Front Page Business

DBS' Q2 profit soars 48% to quarterly record of \$2.69b

Prisca Ang, DBS' Q2 profit soars 48% to quarterly record of \$2.69b

1,036 words

4 August 2023

The Straits Times

STIMES

English

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DBS Group Holdings on Thursday reported record quarterly earnings as higher interest rates continued to lift its margins, and **wealth management** and card fees rebounded after a dry spell.

This comes even as it slightly moderated its expectations for loan and fee income growth in 2023 as the economy slows down and investors exercise caution.

Net profit of the largest lender in Singapore and South-east Asia stood at \$2.69 billion for the second quarter, up 48 per cent from a year ago. It topped the \$2.41 billion forecast by analysts in a Refinitiv poll.

Earnings came in at \$2.63 billion, when \$60 million in one-off integration costs from the acquisition of Citigroup's Taiwan consumer banking business were considered.

The board declared a dividend of 48 cents a share for the second quarter, an increase of six cents a share from the previous quarter.

The growth is in line with the bank's guidance for a baseline annual increase of 24 cents a share, said DBS.

Together with the first-quarter dividend, the total dividend for the first half of 2023 amounts to 90 cents a share.

DBS chief executive Piyush Gupta said the commercial book benefited from higher interest rates and broad-based growth in non-interest income activities, which was moderated by higher funding costs for treasury markets.

"During the quarter, we commenced work to strengthen the resilience of our technology while awaiting completion of the independent review into the recent digital disruptions," he added.

DBS' commercial book's second-quarter net interest income rose 54 per cent year on year to \$3.58 billion. This was driven by a 96 basis point jump in net interest margin (NIM) -- a key gauge of a bank's profitability -- to 2.81 per cent.

Mr Gupta told reporters that the increase in NIM was "a bit of a surprise". The bank said in the first quarter that margins had likely peaked amid expectations that the United States Federal Reserve was coming to the end of its rate-hiking cycle.

"I think there is at least a couple of basis points upside from the second quarter, from where we are," said Mr Gupta, citing US interest rate increases in the second half of 2023 and continued support from one-fifth of the bank's commercial book, which has not been repriced yet.

Commercial book net fee income rose 7 per cent to \$823 million -- the first year-on-year increase in six quarters.

Wealth management fees were buoyed by higher bancassurance and investment product sales, and card fees grew on the back of higher spending, including for travel.

These increases were moderated by a 5 per cent decline in transaction service fees led by trade finance.

Fee income is likely to expand at a high single-digit percentage in the second half, and at a mid-single digit for the full year, said Mr Gupta. He previously expected it to grow at a high single-digit percentage for the full year.

He foresees a further fee income lift from the cards business due to higher spending, and continued momentum in **wealth management**, including from net new money inflows of \$12 billion in the first half of the year.

Half of the inflows have gone to deposits, and the other half to investments, noted Mr Gupta.

"Typically, you'd expect 80 per cent of the money to be invested, so there is upside that if the market starts turning around, that money (in deposits) will go into investments," he said, adding that half of the \$6 billion of net new money inflows in the second quarter came from North Asia.

DBS and its peers are also dealing with weak loan growth in 2023 as economic uncertainty and high interest rates weigh on borrowers' sentiment.

DBS' loans were stable compared with a year ago, but declined 1 per cent from the first quarter due to a contraction in trade loans amid a general market slowdown and unattractive pricing.

Mr Gupta now expects loans to grow at a low single-digit percentage for the full year, from trade and non-trade corporate loans. This is a slight deterioration from his first-quarter forecast of 3 per cent to 5 per cent, and before that, mid-single-digit growth.

"The loan growth problem is not just due to the macro slowdown. It has to do with the fact that a lot of the loans have shifted from our booking centres principally in Hong Kong back to the mainland," he said, citing lower Chinese onshore rates and the renminbi's depreciation.

Chief financial officer Chng Sok Hui noted that a steep rise in the Hong Kong benchmark interest rate has also accelerated repayments on non-trade corporate loans in the city.

Meanwhile, the bank wrote back \$42 million in general allowances previously taken for potential bad loans as the amount was transferred to non-performing assets and credit upgrades.

General allowances of \$57 million were taken in the first half of the year, with \$99 million set aside in the first quarter to strengthen the reserves.

The bank's non-performing loan ratio stood at 1.1 per cent in the second quarter, unchanged over the first six months of the year and an improvement from 1.3 per cent a year ago. New non-performing asset formation remained low and was offset by repayments and write-offs.

Singapore banks' earnings season started on July 27, when UOB reported a 27 per cent increase in net profit to \$1.42 billion. OCBC will post its results on Friday.

DBS shares closed 8 cents, or 0.24 per cent, lower at \$33.76 on Thursday. OCBC fell 15 cents, or 1.14 per cent, to \$13.04, and UOB dipped 10 cents, or 0.33 per cent, to \$29.82.

The DBS board has declared a dividend of 48 cents a share for the second quarter, an increase of six cents a share from the previous quarter. ST PHOTO: CHONG JUN LIANG

Document STIMES0020230803ej840046z

Search Summary

Text	
Date	04/08/2023 to 04/08/2026
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Factiva Expert Search	Wealth Management (English)
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Region	Asia
Language	English

Results Found	666
Timestamp	4 August 2026 16:45